

FlowTrace

User Manual

Surface Well Testing Data Acquisition and Monitoring

Software version 1.6.7

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1 Introduction

FlowTrace is a data acquisition and monitoring application for surface well testing. It reads field sensors through a Modbus device, shows the values live, logs every reading to a database and turns the data into tables, graphs and professional reports.

FlowTrace gives the well test crew one place to gather electronic readings, add measurement calculations (gas, liquid, oil and water rates, SF-DP, choke records), watch the well respond as parameters change and produce the reports the client needs at the end of the job.

What you can do

- Read up to 125 sensor channels from a Modbus device over a serial (COM / RS-485) connection.
- Watch live values in the Live Stream, Monitoring View, Key Parameters and Graphs.
- Log every reading automatically to the Project database and a CSV file.
- Add orifice gas, liquid, oil and water measurement columns, SF-DP and choke records.
- Set alarms on any column, with popup, sound and an Alarm Log.
- Filter, edit and export your data to Excel.
- Build PDF reports in Graph Studio, End of Well Reports (EOWR), calibration reports, delivery notes and P&ID packages.
- Keep each well or job in its own Project.

Concepts

Term	Meaning
Project	One well or job. A Project holds its own settings, channels, measurement columns, database, CSV logs and exports.
Channel	One sensor value read from the Modbus device (for example THP or Separator Temp).
Reading	One row of data: all channel values at one date and time, saved once per Log interval.
Session	One run from Start Monitoring to Stop Monitoring. Every Start creates a new session.
Measurement column	A calculated column added from the Measurement menu (gas rate, liquid rate, SF-DP ...).
Virtual column	Your own calculated column, built from channels with the Formula Builder.

About this manual

Every screen in this manual is a real screenshot of FlowTrace. The sample Project shown is *Demo Well*, a six-hour flowback test with three choke changes. Your screens show your own Project, channels and data.

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Tip Press **F1** anywhere in FlowTrace to open the built-in Help, which follows the same topics as this manual.

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2 Installation and Activation

Installing FlowTrace

1. Run **FlowTrace_Setup.exe** and follow the installer.
2. Start FlowTrace from the desktop or Start menu shortcut.
3. The first time FlowTrace starts, type a name for your first Project (for example the well name).

To update, run the new installer. It upgrades the existing installation in place and keeps all your Projects and settings. Close FlowTrace before installing, or let the installer close it for you.

Activation

FlowTrace needs an activation key made for this computer. A key works only on the computer it was made for.

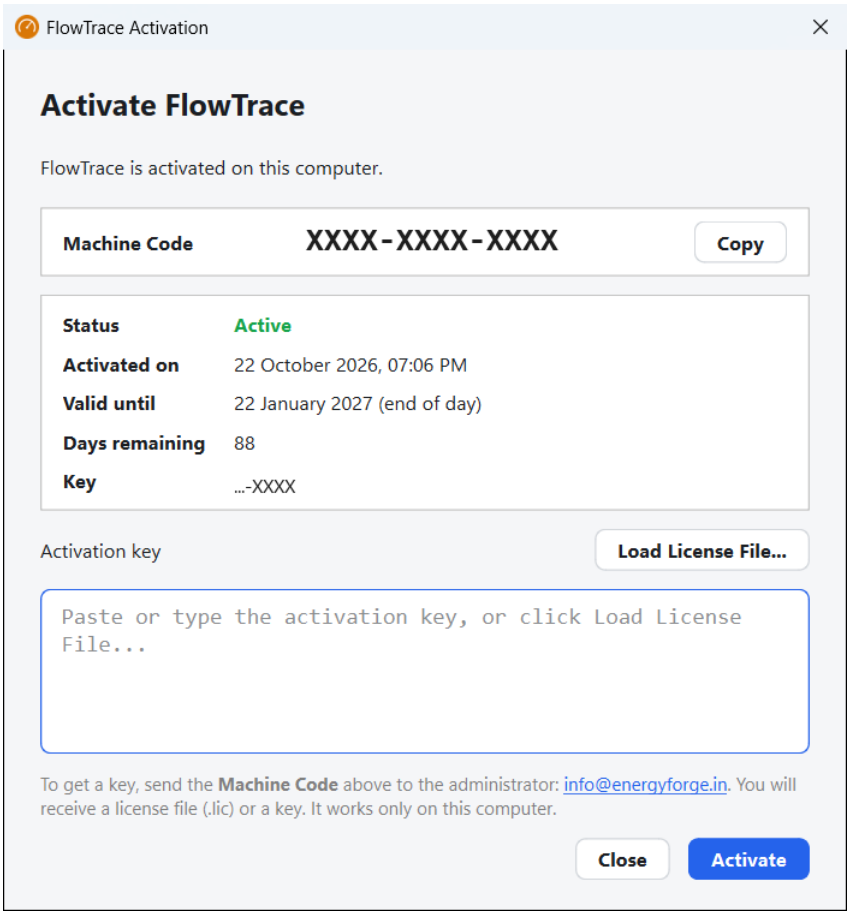


Figure 1: FlowTrace Activation window (Activation > Activate / Renew...)

1. Open **Activation > Activate / Renew...**. The window shows this computer's **Machine Code**.
2. Send the Machine Code to the administrator (phone, WhatsApp or email). **Copy** copies it. No internet is needed on this computer.
3. You receive a license file (.lic) or a key. Click **Load License File...**, or paste the key and click **Activate**.

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License status

The license status is always shown at the bottom left of the main window. Click it to open the Activation window.

Status shown	Meaning
Licensed · N days left	Full license, active.
Trial · N days left	Time-limited trial license.
License expires in N days	Fewer than 15 days left. Ask for a renewal key.
License expired	Enter a new key to continue.
License cancelled	The administrator cancelled this computer's license.

- In the last 15 days a reminder appears every time FlowTrace is opened, and while it stays open (once a day, twice a day in the last 7 days).
- When the license ends, monitoring stops. All data logged so far is kept.
- A new computer, a Windows reinstall or a motherboard change gives a new Machine Code and needs a new key.

Important Your data is never deleted when a license expires or is cancelled. For a new key contact info@energyforge.in.

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3 Screen Layout

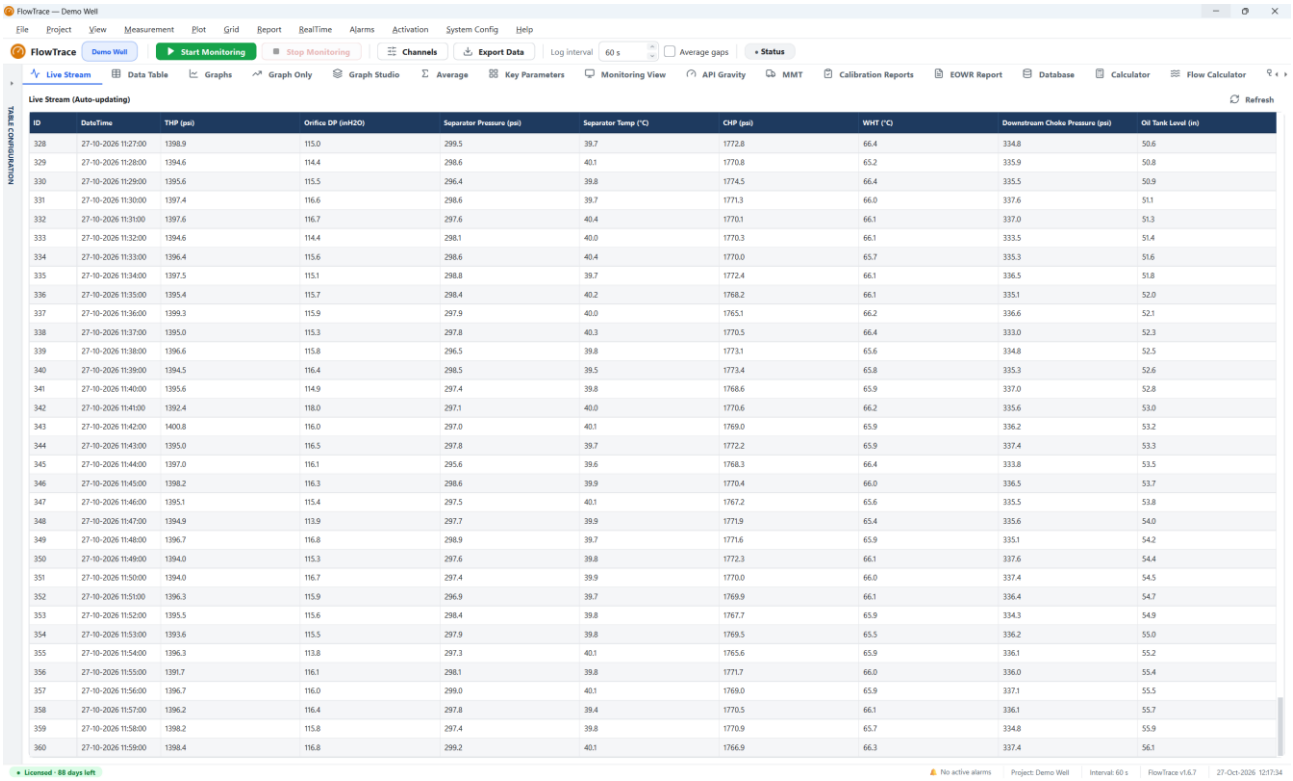


Figure 2: The FlowTrace main window

The FlowTrace window has five main areas:

Area	What it is for
Menu bar	File, Project, View, Measurement, Plot, Grid, Report, RealTime, Alarms, Activation, System Config and Help.
Toolbar	Active Project name, Start / Stop Monitoring, Channels, Export Data, Log interval, Average gaps and the monitoring status.
Sidebar (left)	Table Configuration: choose which columns are shown. Open or close it with the arrow button.
Tabs	Live Stream, Data Table, Graphs, Graph Only, Graph Studio, Average, Key Parameters, Monitoring View, API Gravity, MMT, Calibration Reports, EOWR Report, Database, Calculator, Flow Calculator and P&ID.
Status bar (bottom)	License status, messages, active alarms, Project, log interval, version and clock.

Tip Every tab can also be opened from the **View** menu. On smaller screens some toolbar buttons show only their icon; hover over an icon to see its name.

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Menu Bar

The menus give access to every function of FlowTrace.

File: export data, column order and visibility, Save Project As, Exit.

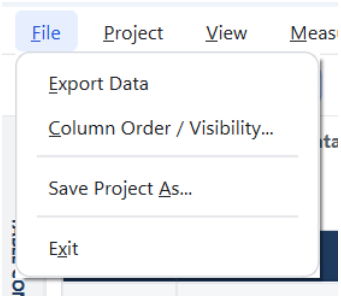


Figure 3: File menu

Project: shows the current Project; New, Open and Import Project.

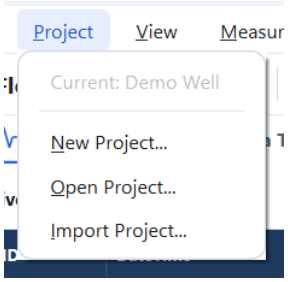


Figure 4: Project menu

View: jump to any tab, show hidden tabs, and choose the Light or Dark theme.

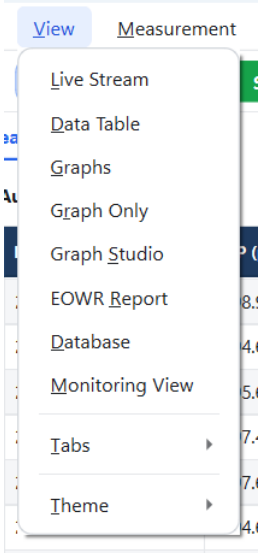


Figure 5: View menu

Measurement: channels and all measurement tools (liquid, orifice gas, oil, water, SF-DP, choke).

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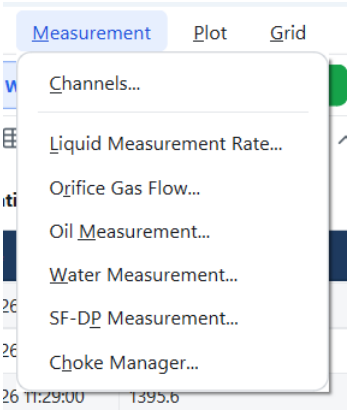


Figure 6: Measurement menu

Alarms: active alarms and Alarm Log, Acknowledge All (Ctrl+Shift+A), fire extinguisher expiry check.

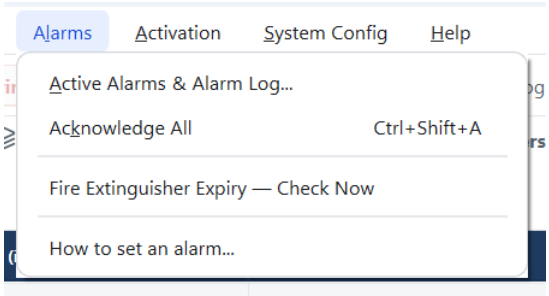


Figure 7: Alarms menu

Help: FlowTrace Help (F1), What's New, Quick Start Guide, Troubleshooting and About.

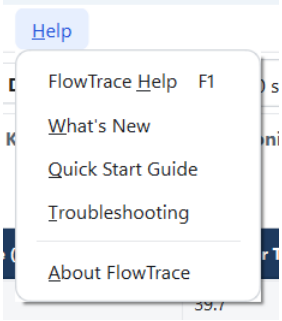


Figure 8: Help menu

Menu	Items
Plot	Open Graphs, Graph Only, Full Screen Graph.
Grid	Data Table, Resize Columns to Fit.
Report	Export Data.
RealTime	Start Monitoring, Stop Monitoring.
Activation	License status, Activate / Renew...

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System Config	Opens the System Configuration window directly (connection and storage).

Toolbar

Control	Use
Project name	The active Project.
Start Monitoring	Connects to the device and starts logging readings.
Stop Monitoring	Stops logging. All logged data stays saved.
Channels	Opens Channel Configuration.
Export Data	Exports the Data Table to Excel.
Log interval	How often a reading is saved (1 to 300 seconds).
Average gaps	Saves the average of the readings taken during each interval instead of a single reading.
Status	Monitoring status: Connecting, Live, No data or Stopped.

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Table Configuration Sidebar

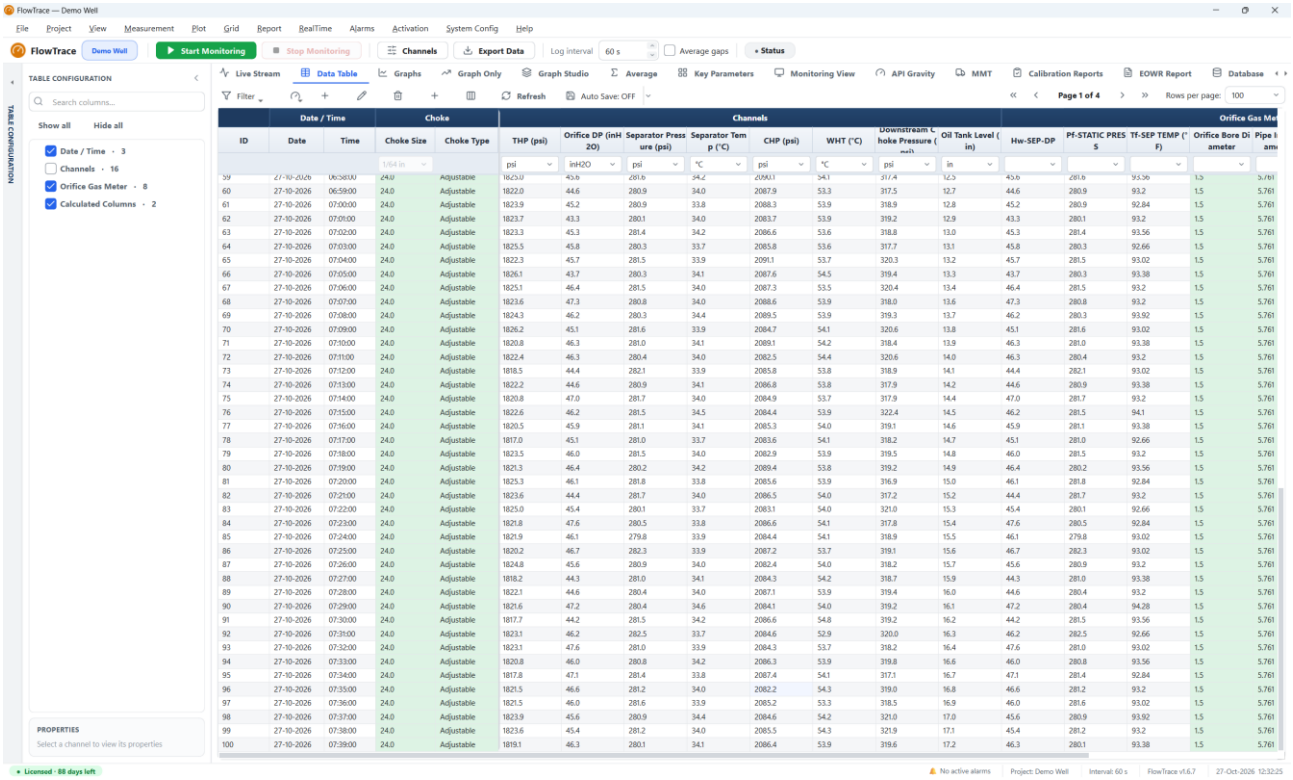


Figure 9: Table Configuration sidebar open beside the Data Table

The sidebar controls which columns are shown in the Data Table, the Database tab and Excel exports.

- Type in the search box to find a column.
- Tick or untick a column to show or hide it. Ticking a group heading shows or hides the whole group.
- Use **Show all** / **Hide all** to change everything at once.
- Select a column to see its details in the **Properties** panel.

Important Hiding a column never deletes its data. Tick it again to bring it back.

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4 Projects

A Project keeps everything for one job together: settings, channels, measurement columns, the database, CSV logs and exports. Switching Project switches all of it.

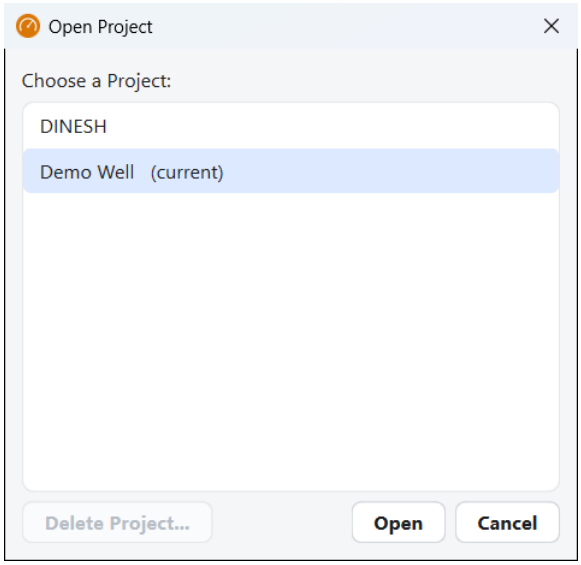


Figure 10: Open Project window (Project > Open Project...)

To do this	Use
Start a new job with empty data	Project > New Project...
Go back to an earlier job	Project > Open Project...
Bring in a Project from another PC or a backup	Project > Import Project...
Make a full copy of the current Project (backup or sharing)	File > Save Project As...

Important Opening, creating or importing a Project never deletes another Project. Import only copies the folder you choose.

Quick Start: your first live reading

1. **Create a Project** for the job: Project > New Project..., type the well name, click OK.
2. **Connect the hardware.** Plug the Modbus device (or USB-to-RS485 converter) into the computer and power it on.
3. **Set up the connection** in System Config (chapter 5).
4. **Name your channels** in Channels (chapter 5).
5. **Choose the Log interval** in the toolbar, for example 60 s for one reading per minute.

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6. **Click Start Monitoring.** The status changes to Live when the device answers and readings appear in the Live Stream.

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5 Device Connection and Channels

System Configuration

Click **System Config** in the menu bar (next to Help).

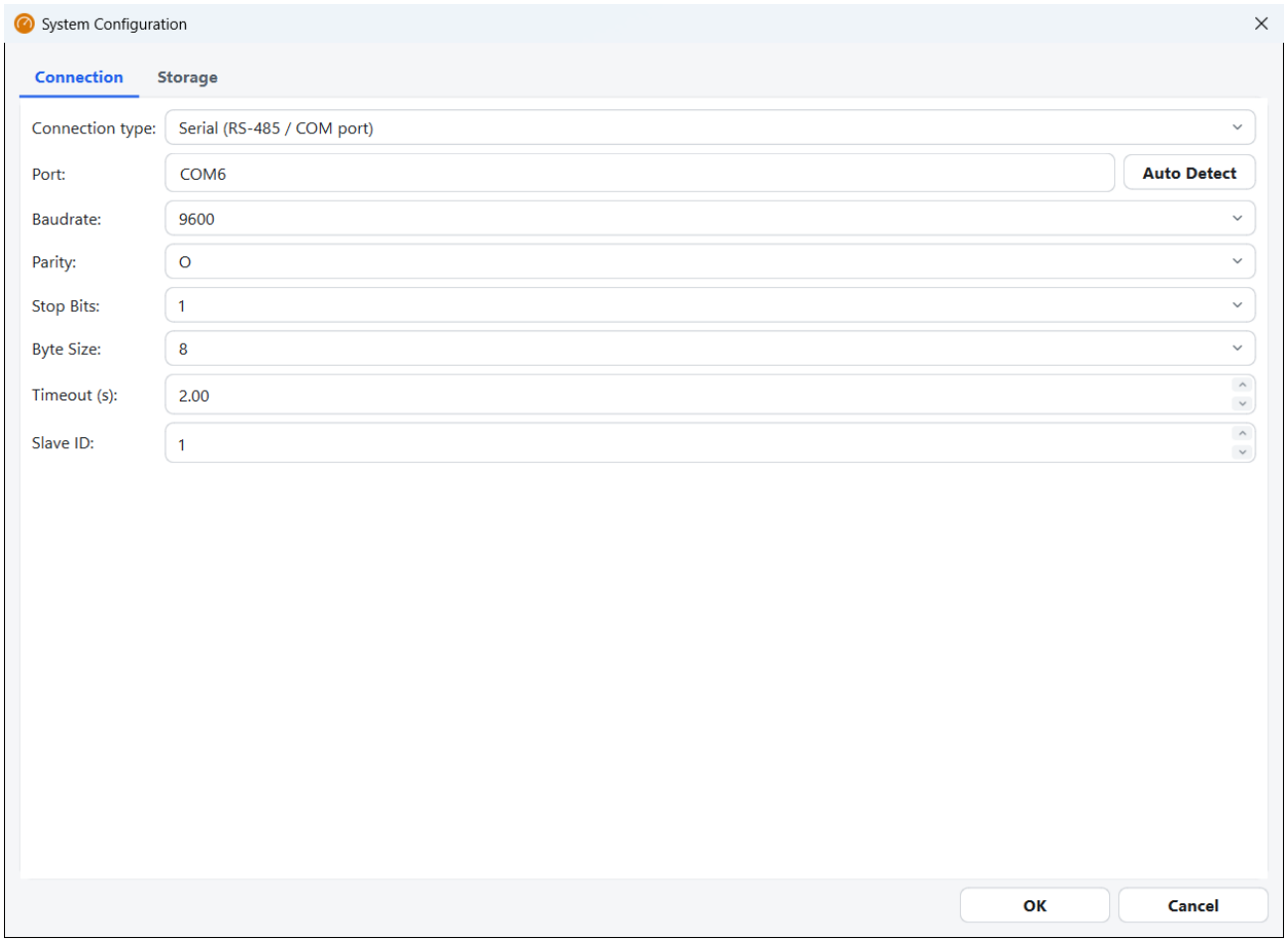


Figure 11: System Configuration, Connection tab

Setting	What to enter
Connection type	Serial (RS-485 / COM port).
Port	The COM port of the device or converter (see Windows Device Manager). **Auto Detect** finds it for you.
Baudrate	Communication speed, for example 9600.
Parity	None, Even or Odd. Must match the device.
Stop Bits / Byte Size	Usually 1 and 8.

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Timeout (s)	How long to wait for an answer before retrying.
Slave ID	The Modbus address of the device.

On the **Storage** tab you can change the Export Path (CSV logs and exports) and the Database Path. Click **OK** to save.

> **Tip** If you are not sure of the settings, check the device label or manual. A mismatch in Baudrate or Parity is the most common reason for no data.

Channel Configuration

Channels are the sensor values FlowTrace reads from the device. Click **Channels** in the toolbar or **Measurement > Channels...**.

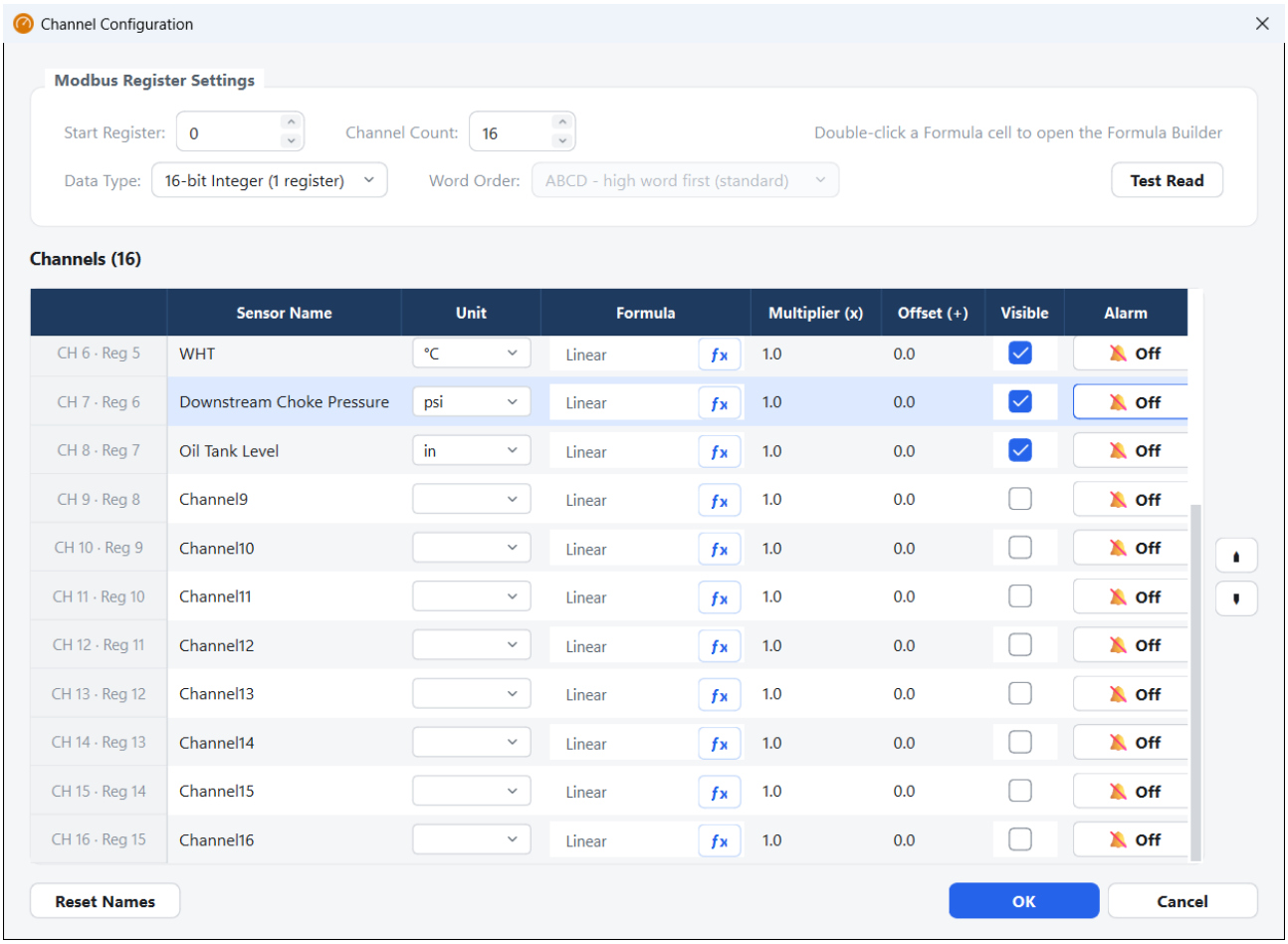


Figure 12: Channel Configuration

1. Set **Start Register** (the first register to read), **Channel Count** (1 to 125), **Data Type** and **Word Order**.
2. Fill in one row per channel (see the table below).
3. Use **Test Read** to check the values the device returns before you start.

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4. Click **OK**. The new names and units appear in every tab.

Column	Use
Sensor Name	A clear name, for example THP or Separator Temp.
Unit	The unit the value is shown in.
Formula	Click **fx** to open the Formula Builder when the raw value needs converting. Leave Linear for a direct reading.
Multiplier (x) / Offset (+)	Scale and shift the value for calibration.
Visible	Untick to hide a channel you do not need.
Alarm	Set warning / alarm levels for the channel (see chapter 9).

Start and Stop Monitoring

1. Set **Log interval** in the toolbar. Optionally tick **Average gaps**.
2. Click **Start Monitoring** (also in the RealTime menu). FlowTrace tries to connect up to 3 times and shows each attempt.
3. Click **Stop Monitoring** when the job is done.

- Every Start creates a new logging session, so separate runs are never mixed.
- Each saved reading goes to the Project database and to a CSV file in the Live Log CSV folder.
- The Live Stream, Data Table, Graphs and Monitoring View update automatically.

Important Log interval and Average gaps can only be changed while monitoring is stopped.

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6 Viewing Data

Live Stream

The Live Stream tab shows the 50 latest readings with one column per channel. The table follows the newest reading automatically.

- Scroll up to look at earlier rows; the table stays where you are until you scroll back to the bottom.
- Drag a column border to resize a column; your widths are kept.
- Click **Refresh** to reload from the database.

Data Table

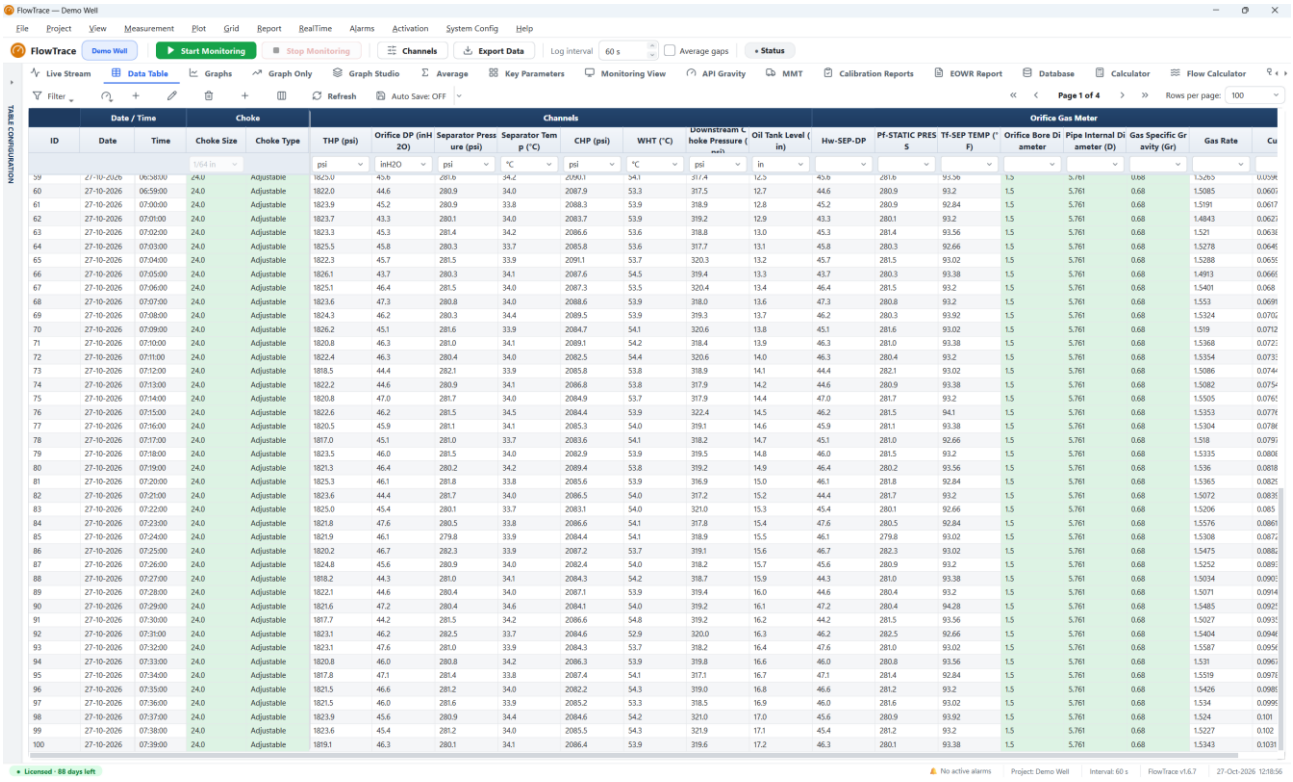


Figure 13: Data Table with grouped headers: Date / Time, Choke, Channels and Orifice Gas Meter

The Data Table is the main grid: one row per saved reading, one column per channel and measurement column.

Find the rows you need

1. Click **Filter** in the Data Table toolbar.
2. Set the Start and End date / time.
3. Optional: choose an Interval Filter (seconds, minutes or hours) to show one row per interval.
4. Click **Apply Filter**. **Reset** returns to today's full day.

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Work with records

Button	Use
Add Record	Add a reading by hand.
Edit Record	Change the selected reading.
Delete Record	Remove the selected reading (you are asked to confirm).
Add Virtual Column	Add your own calculated column.
Reorder Columns	Change the column order and visibility.

Headings, units and colors

- A band above the headings groups the columns: Date / Time, Choke, Channels and each measurement.
- Under every heading you can pick or type a unit label. It is a label only and never changes a value; to convert values, change the unit in Channels.
- Green cells are values entered by the engineer (choke, BS&W, orifice data); a darker shade marks the row where the value was changed.
- Double-click an editable cell to change it directly.
- **Auto Save** saves the table to Excel on a timer; the arrow next to it sets the interval.
- Use rows-per-page and the First / Previous / Next / Last buttons to move through large data sets.
- Sensor re-wired to another channel mid-job? Right-click that channel heading and choose **Sensor moved to another channel...**; earlier readings stay on the old channel.

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Column order and visibility

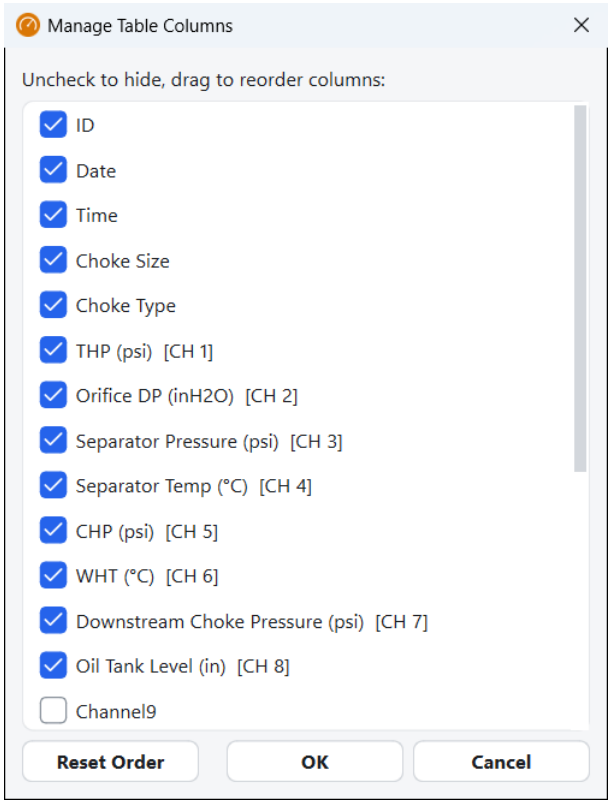


Figure 14: Manage Table Columns (File > Column Order / Visibility...)

Untick a column to hide it and drag to change the order. **Reset Order** restores the default order.

Monitoring View

Monitoring View is a compact window with the current value of every channel and measurement column, grouped the same way as the sidebar. Click the **Monitoring View** tab; it opens as a separate window you can keep beside the main window or move to a second screen.

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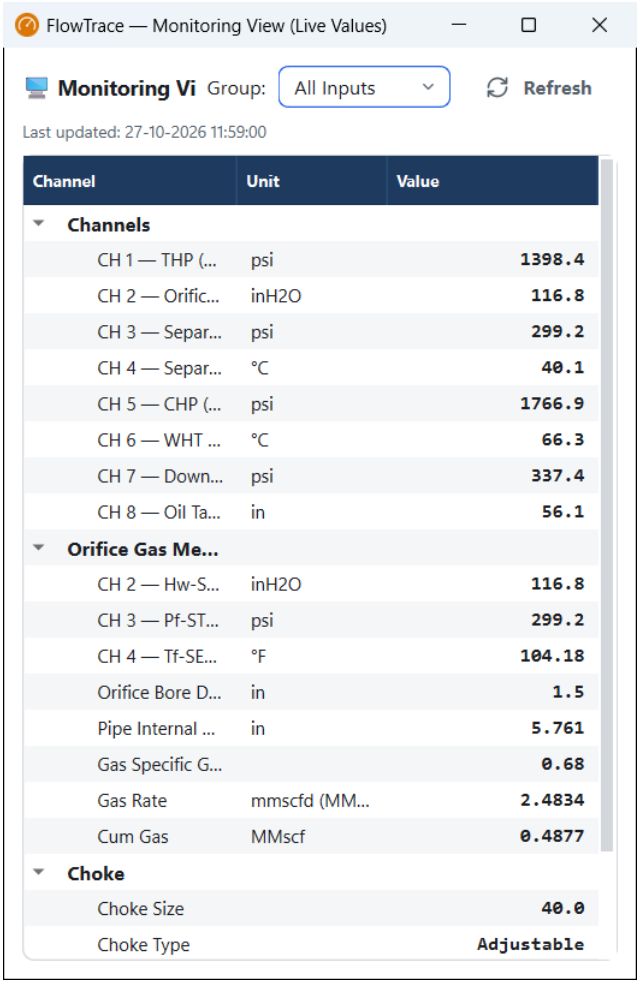


Figure 15: Monitoring View window

- Use the **Group** filter to show one group only, or All Inputs for everything.
- Values refresh every second while monitoring.
- Clicking the tab again brings the same window to the front; its size and position are remembered.

Key Parameters

Key Parameters shows the channels you choose as large cards that can be read from across the cabin. Like Monitoring View, it opens as its own window.

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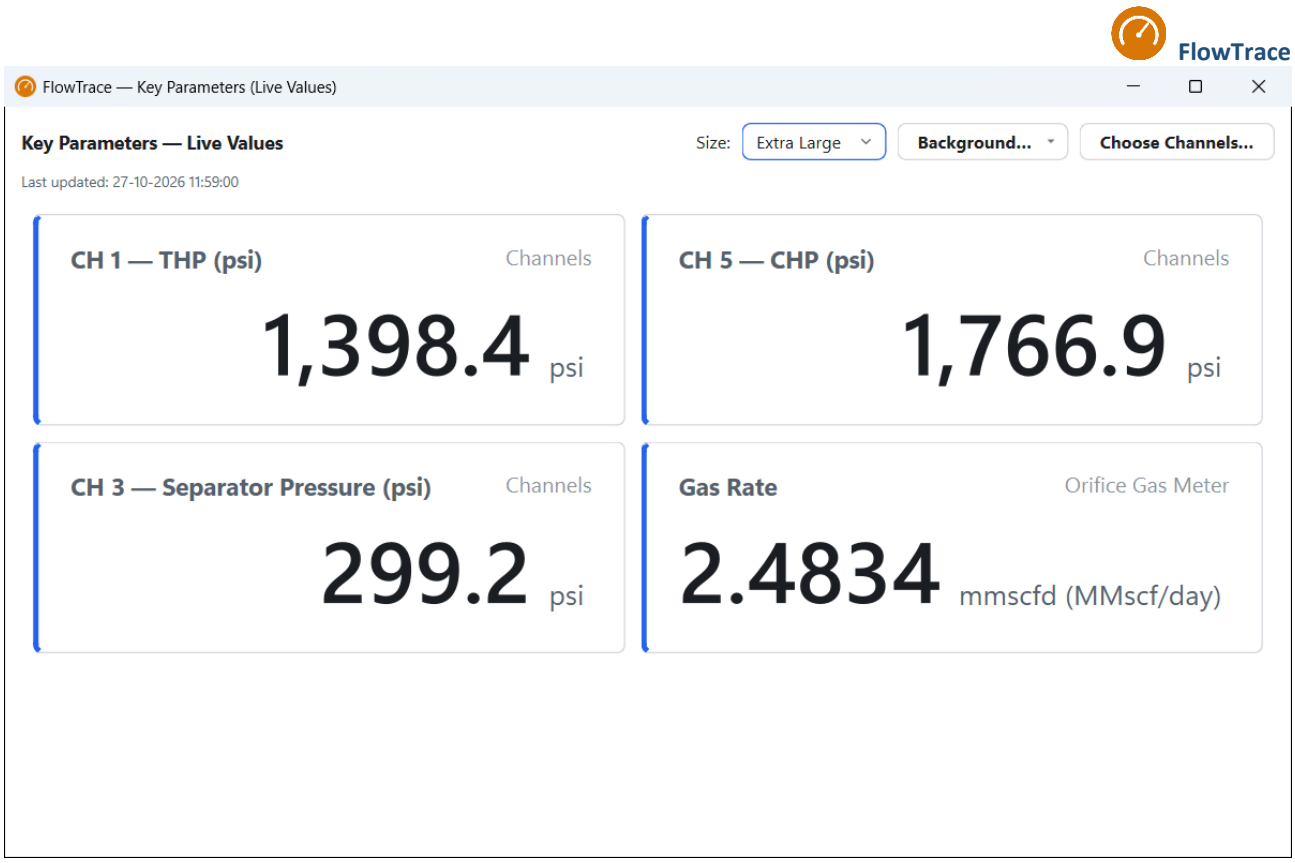


Figure 16: Key Parameters window

- **Choose Channels...** picks the cards to show.
- **Size** sets the card size and **Background...** the card color.
- Each card shows the channel number, name, value and unit.

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7 Measurement Tools

The Measurement menu adds ready-made measurement columns to your data. They all work the same way:

1. Open the tool from the **Measurement** menu.
2. Choose which sensor channel feeds each input, or enter a fixed value where offered.
3. Enter the meter or job parameters.
4. Click **Save as Column** / **Save Config**.

The new columns appear as their own group in the Data Table, the sidebar, Monitoring View and Excel exports, and are filled in automatically for every reading.

Important When you change parameters later, the new values apply from that moment on. Readings already logged keep the values they were calculated with.

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Orifice Gas Flow (AGA-3)

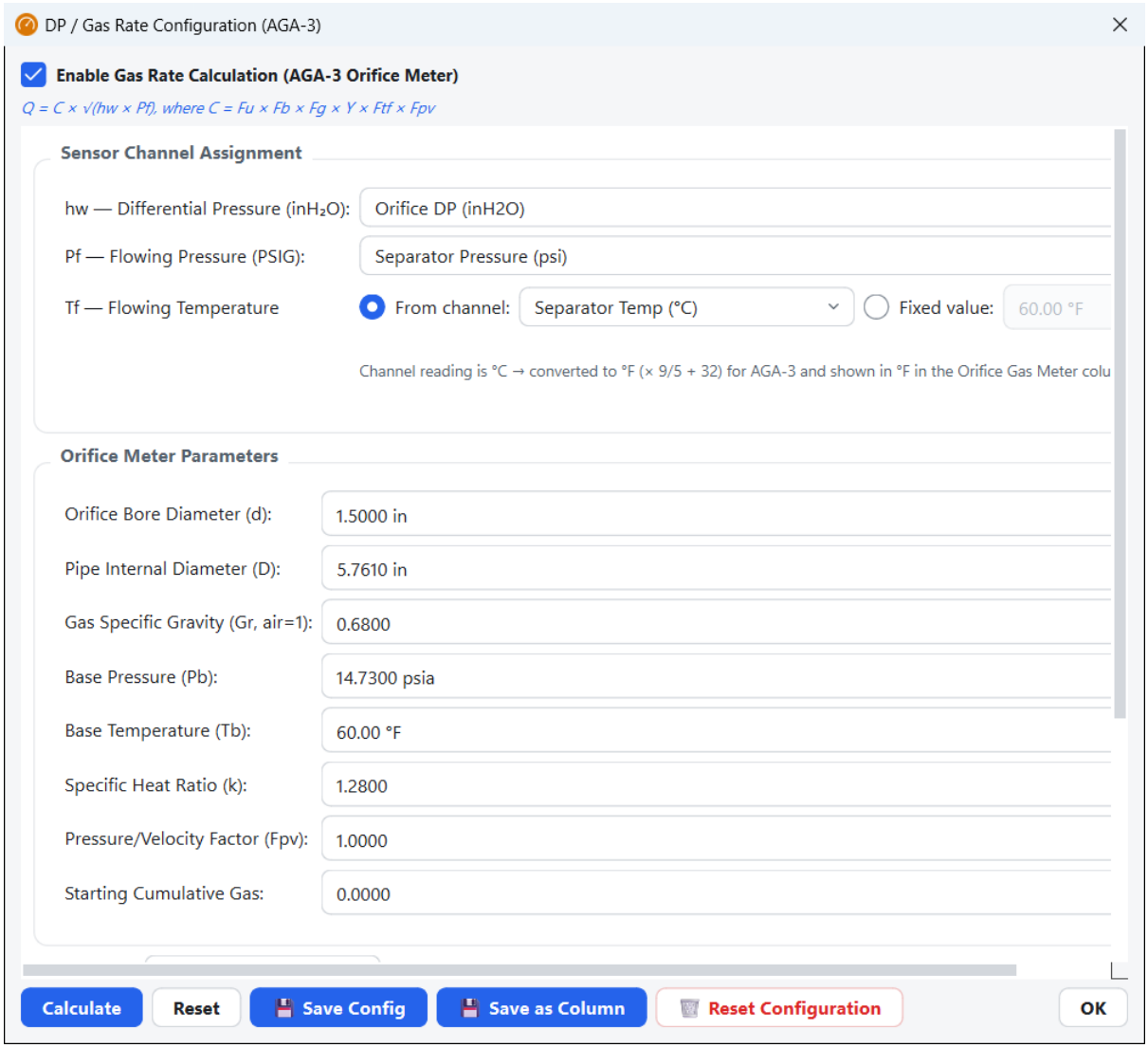


Figure 17: DP / Gas Rate Configuration (Measurement > Orifice Gas Flow...)

1. Open **Measurement > Orifice Gas Flow...** and tick **Enable Gas Rate Calculation**.
2. Under Sensor Channel Assignment choose the **hw** (differential pressure), **Pf** (flowing pressure) and **Tf** (flowing temperature) channels. Tf can also be a fixed value.
3. Enter the orifice bore diameter, pipe internal diameter, gas specific gravity, base pressure and temperature, k, Fpv and the starting cumulative gas.
4. Choose the output unit.
5. Click **Calculate** to preview with the latest reading.
6. Click **Save as Column** to add the gas rate and cumulative gas columns.

The gas rate follows the AGA-3 orifice equation: Q = C × √(hw × Pf), where C = Fu × Fb × Fg × Y × Ftf × Fpv. A Tf channel is read in °C and converted to °F for the calculation.

Tip If the orifice plate is changed during the job, double-click the bore diameter cell in the Data Table at the row where it changed. The new value applies from that row onward.

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Liquid, Oil and Water Measurement

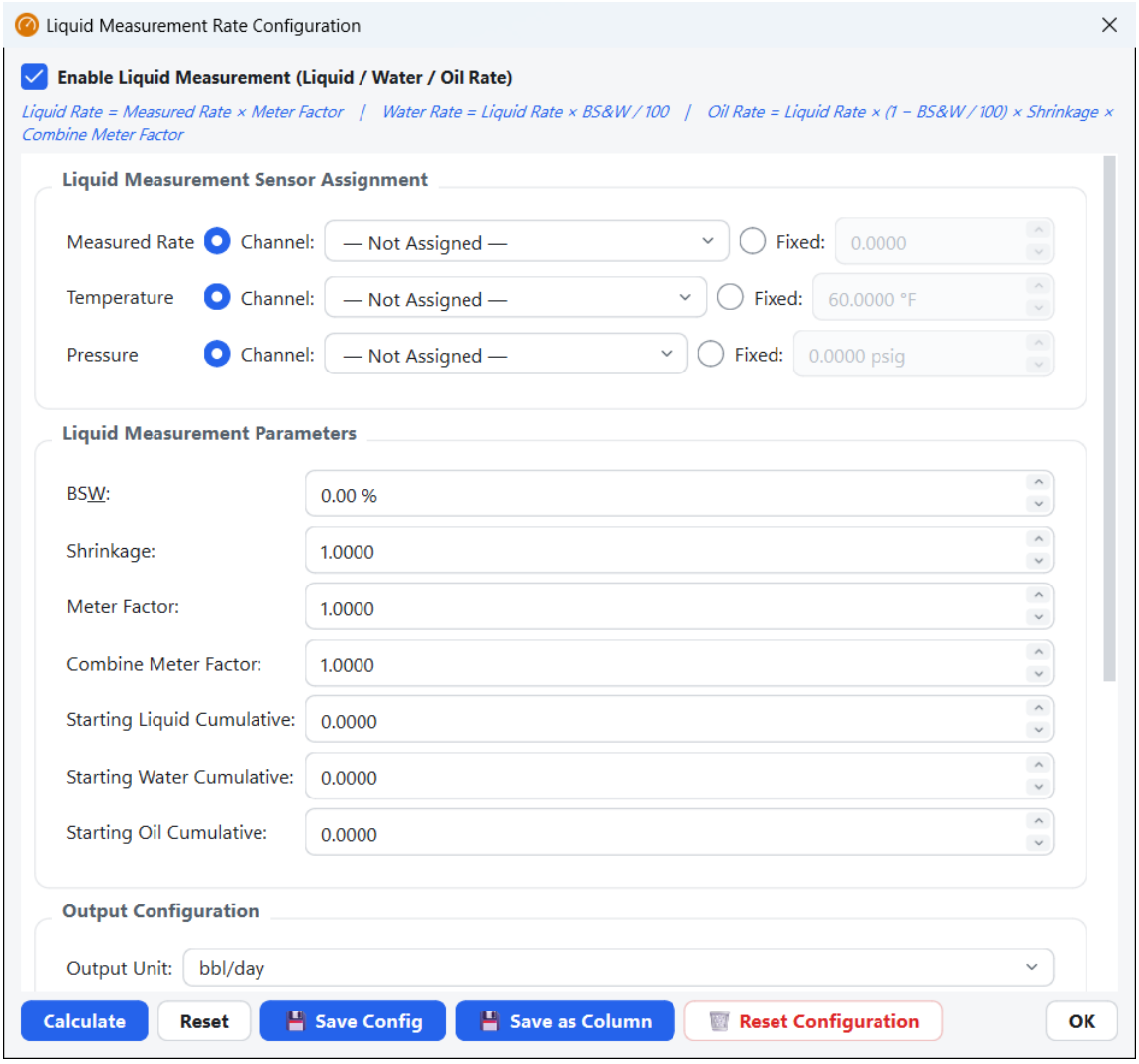


Figure 18: Liquid Measurement Rate Configuration

1. Open **Measurement > Liquid Measurement Rate...**, **Oil Measurement...** or **Water Measurement...**.
2. Assign the measured rate sensor and, where asked, the temperature and pressure sensors (or fixed values).
3. Enter BS&W, shrinkage, meter factor, combine meter factor and starting cumulatives.
4. Choose the output unit and click **Save as Column**. Rate and cumulative columns are added and fill in automatically.

Liquid Rate = Measured Rate × Meter Factor; Water Rate = Liquid Rate × BS&W / 100; Oil Rate = Liquid Rate × (1 − BS&W / 100) × Shrinkage × Combine Meter Factor.

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SF-DP Measurement

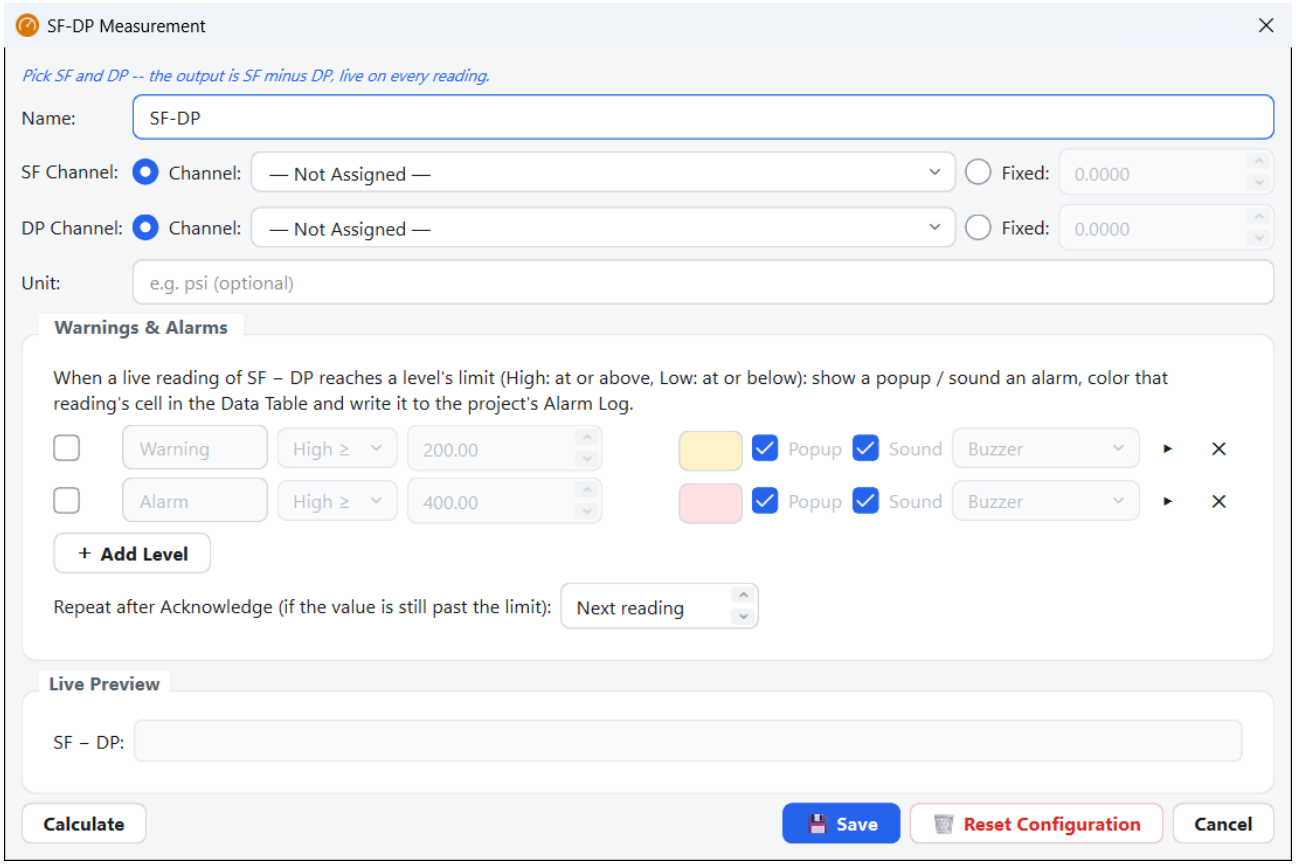


Figure 19: SF-DP Measurement

1. Open **Measurement > SF-DP Measurement...**.
2. Choose the SF channel and the DP channel (or a fixed value for either) and an optional unit.
3. Optional: under **Warnings & Alarms** add levels (High or Low), each with a limit, color, popup and sound.
4. Click **Save**. The SF − DP value is calculated for every reading.

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Choke Manager

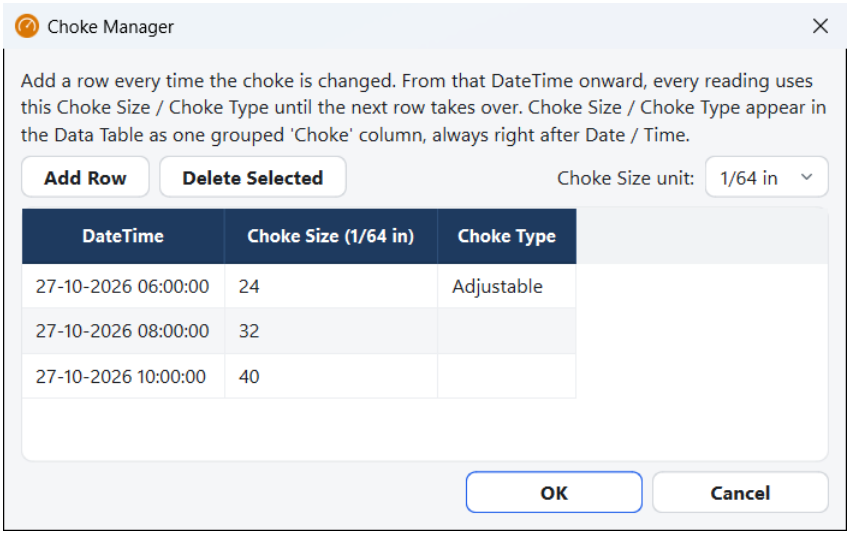


Figure 20: Choke Manager with three choke changes

Record the choke size and type used during the test, so every reading shows the choke in service at that time.

1. Open **Measurement > Choke Manager...**.
2. Click **Add Row** each time the choke is changed and enter the date / time, choke size and choke type.
3. Choose the **Choke Size unit**.
4. Click **OK**. Every reading from that time on shows that choke, until the next change.

Virtual Columns

1. In the Data Table click **Add Virtual Column**.
2. Give the column a name and unit.
3. Build the expression from your channels in the Formula Builder.
4. Save. The column is calculated for every reading, old and new.

Tip Virtual columns appear in the sidebar, so they can be shown, hidden and reordered like any other column.

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8 Graphs

Graphs Tab

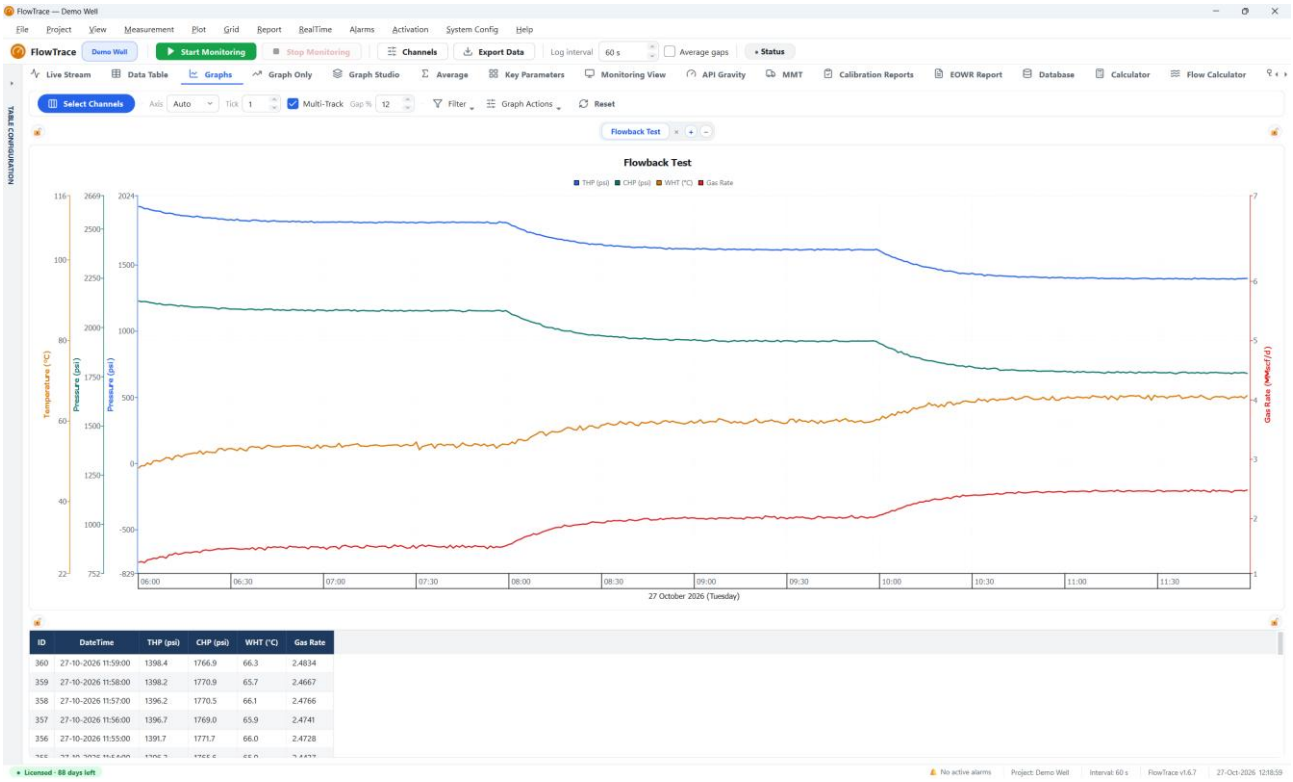


Figure 21: Graphs tab: THP, CHP, WHT and Gas Rate over a six-hour flowback test

1. Open the **Graphs** tab.
2. Click **Select Channels** to choose the channels to plot, their Y-axis and line color.
3. Click **Filter**, set the date / time range and interval, then **Apply Filter**. **Reset** clears the filter.
4. Optional: tick **Multi-Track** to give each channel its own band.

- Hover over a line to read the exact value and time.
- Right-click the chart to add, edit or remove an annotation.
- The table under the chart lists the plotted values.

Zoom, move and lock

- Scroll the mouse wheel over the chart to zoom the time axis; drag inside the chart to move along time.
- Grab a Y-axis and drag it up or down to move it; drag near its top or bottom end to stretch it.
- The padlocks at the chart corners lock an edge: the two top padlocks fix the Y-axis tops, the two bottom padlocks fix the time start / end.

Graph profiles

The strip above the chart holds separate saved graphs, each with its own channels, axes and locks. Click **+** to add a graph, **–** to remove the current one, and click a name to switch. Right-click a name to rename it.

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Graph Actions menu

- **Export Graph Data**: the plotted data to Excel.
- **Export Graph as PDF**.
- **Reset View**: undo zoom, moves and locks.
- **Full Screen**: press Esc to leave.

Graph Only and Full Screen

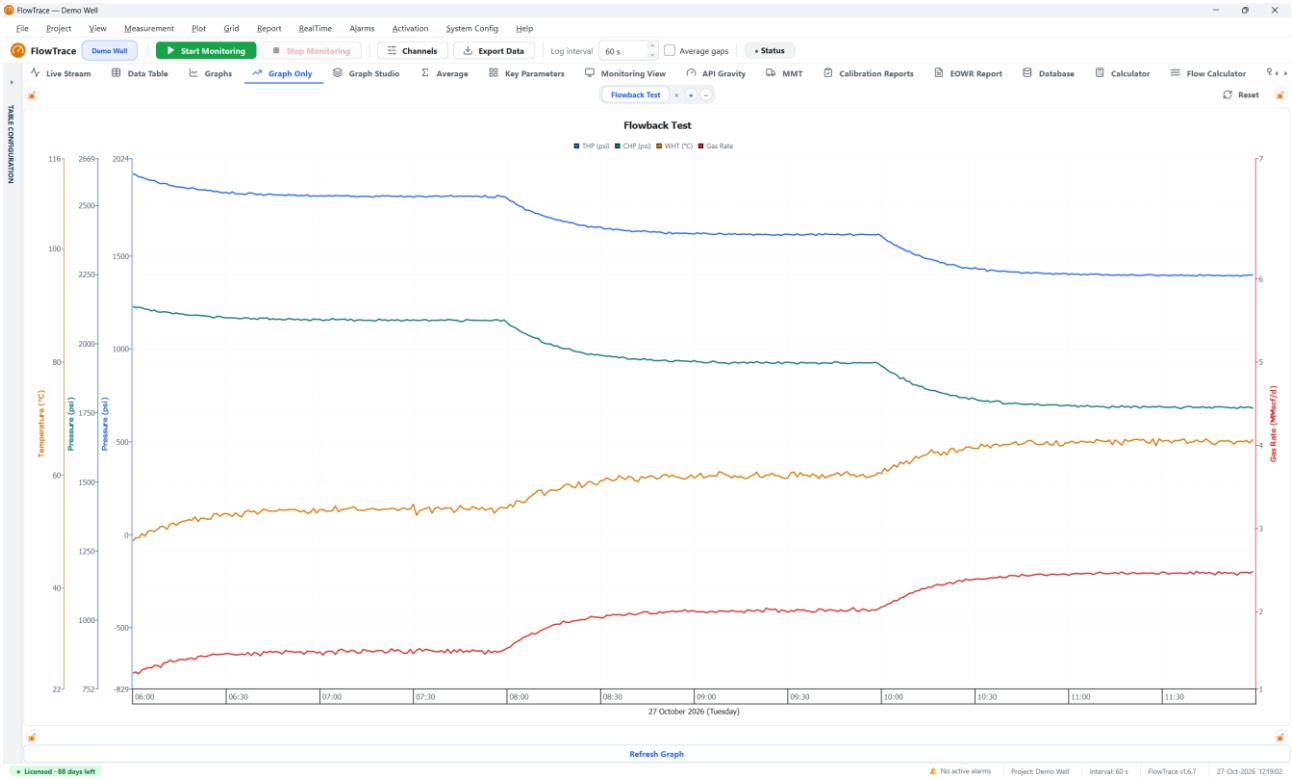


Figure 22: Graph Only tab

The Graph Only tab shows the same chart with nothing else on screen, ideal for a second monitor. **Plot > Full Screen Graph** fills the whole screen; press Esc to exit.

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Graph Studio (PDF Reports)

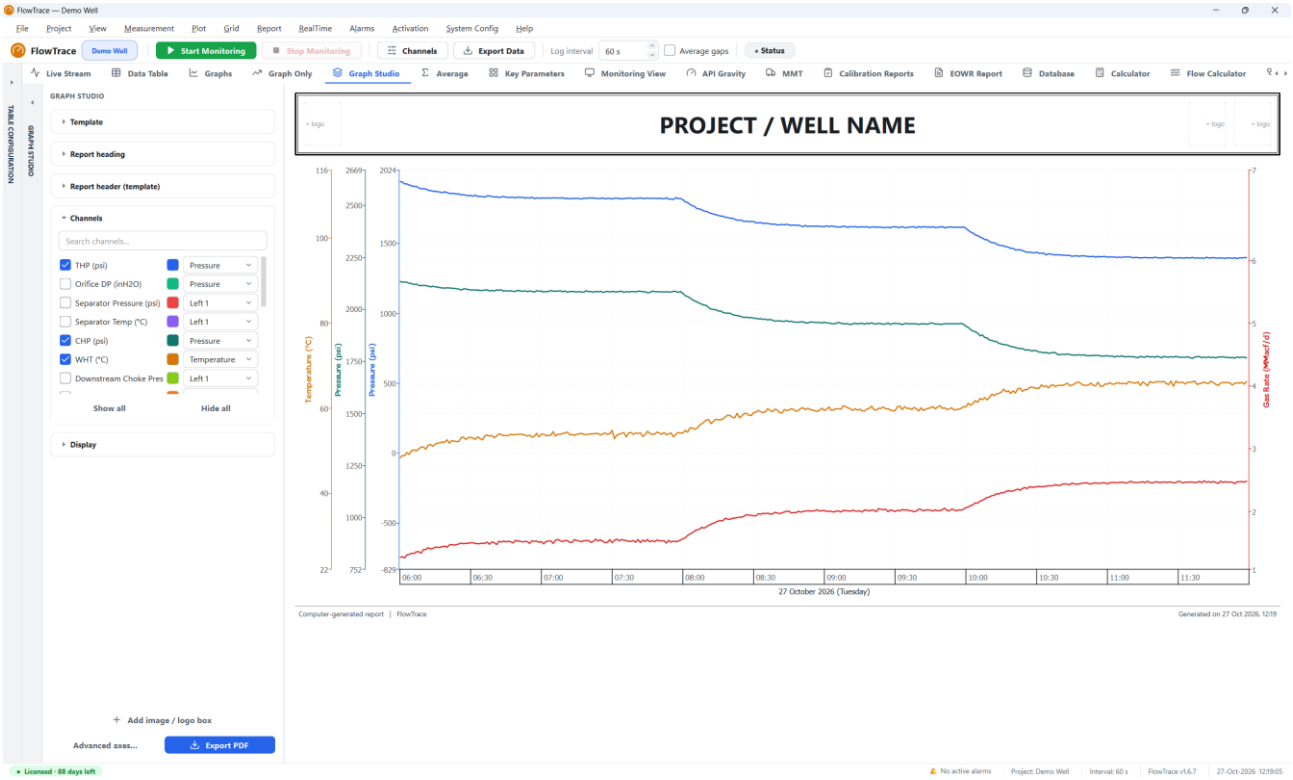


Figure 23: Graph Studio report page preview

Graph Studio builds a finished report page: header band with logos, title, subtitle, chart, notes and footer.

1. **Template**: pick a saved template or create a new one.
2. **Report heading**: type the title, subtitle, footer and notes.
3. **Report header**: type the well name. Click a dashed logo box to add a logo (left = your company, right = client).
4. **Channels**: choose what to plot and set the time range.
5. **Display**: adjust colors, axes and style.
6. Click **Export PDF** and choose where to save the file. The PDF matches the preview exactly.

Tip Save the look as a Template once and reuse it for every well. Templates keep the style only, not the data.

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9 Alarms

Any Data Table column can have an alarm: channels, gas rate, cumulative gas, liquid / oil / water, SF-DP and virtual columns.

1. In the Data Table, right-click the column heading and choose **Alarm...**.
2. Add up to 5 levels. Each level is **High** (at or above the limit) or **Low** (at or below) with its own name, limit, color, popup and sound.
3. Set **Repeat after Acknowledge** if the alarm should come back while the value stays past the limit.

Channels can also be set in Measurement > Channels (Alarm column), and SF-DP in its own window.

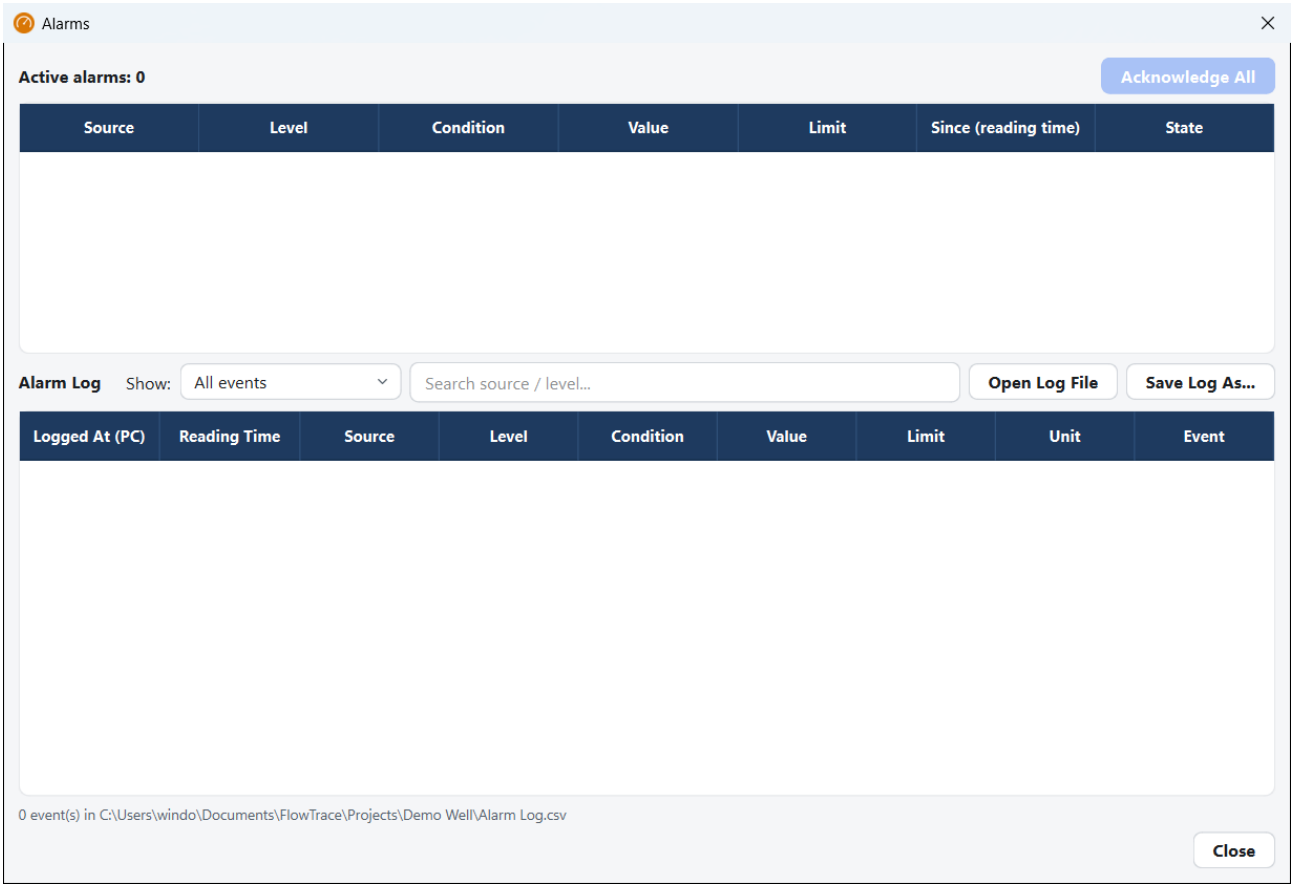


Figure 24: Alarms window: active alarms and Alarm Log

- **Alarms > Active Alarms & Alarm Log...** lists the alarms that are active now and every alarm event.
- **Acknowledge All** (Ctrl+Shift+A) acknowledges every active alarm.
- Every alarm, acknowledge and return to normal is written to the Project's Alarm Log. **Save Log As...** saves a copy.
- **Fire Extinguisher Expiry — Check Now** shows the fire extinguisher expiry alarm at once instead of waiting for the scheduled day / night reminder.

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10 Reports and Export

Export Data to Excel

1. Filter the Data Table to the rows you want and choose the columns in the sidebar.
2. Click **Export Data** (toolbar, File menu or Report menu).
3. Choose where to save the file.

The workbook has the same grouped headers as the Data Table and includes an image of the current graph.

> **Important** If the export fails, the target file is probably open in Excel. Close it and export again.

EOWR Report (End of Well Report)

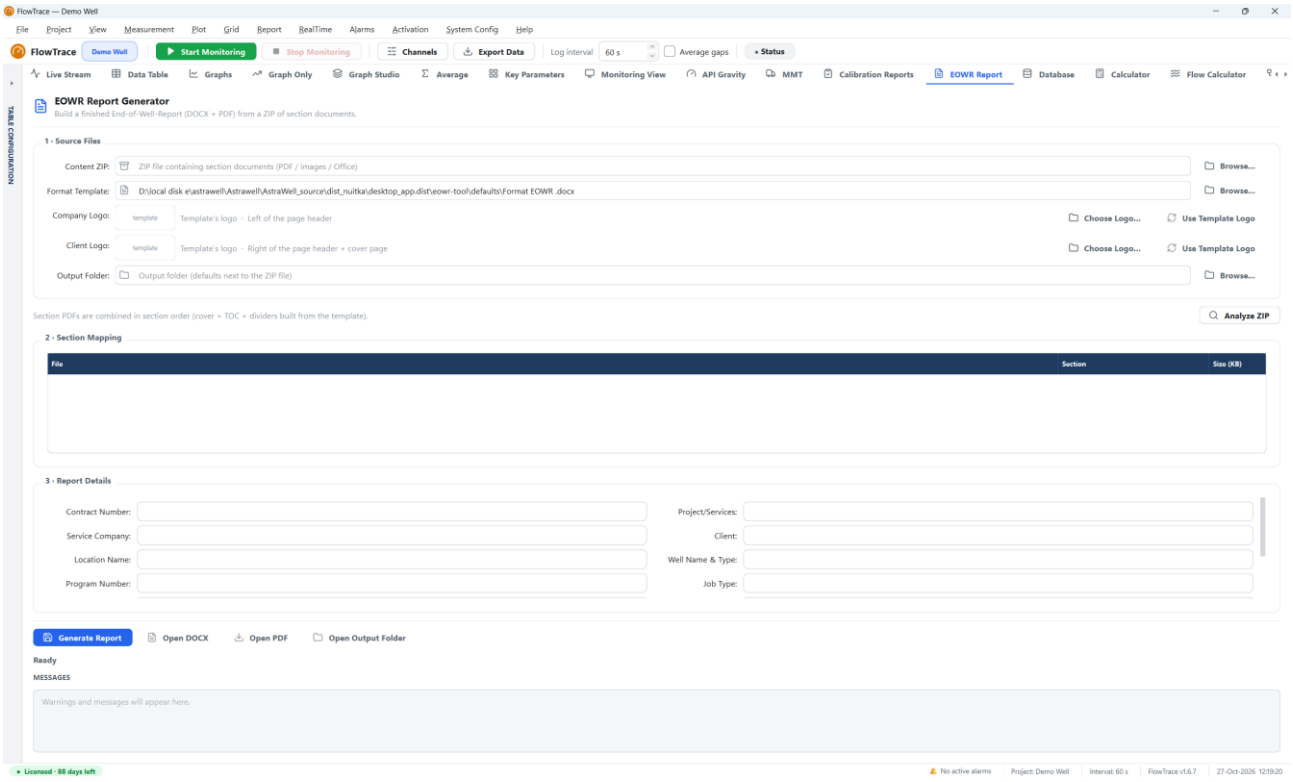


Figure 25: EOWR Report Generator

1. **Source Files**: choose the content ZIP (PDFs, images, Office files), the Word format template (a default is provided) and the output folder.
2. **Logos** (optional): next to Company Logo and Client Logo click **Choose Logo...**. The company logo goes on the left of the page header, the client logo on the right and on the cover page.
3. **Section Mapping**: click **Analyze ZIP** and check which report section each file goes into.
4. **Report Details**: fill in the cover and header fields.
5. Click **Generate Report** and wait for the progress bar to finish.
6. Use **Open DOCX**, **Open PDF** or **Open Output Folder** to see the result.

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Important Converting Word, Excel and PowerPoint files needs Microsoft Office on this computer.

MMT: Delivery Note and MMR

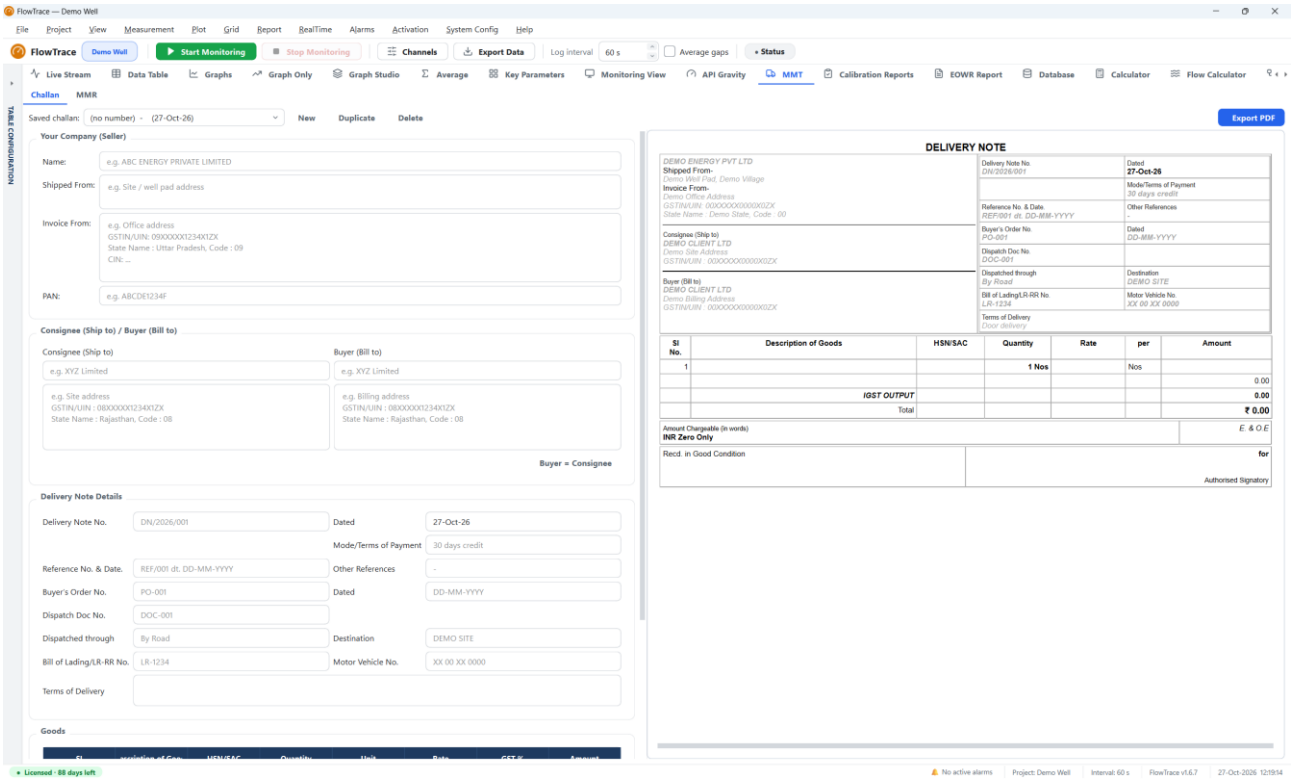


Figure 26: MMT tab: Delivery Note (Challan) with live preview

The MMT tab prepares material movement documents. The **Challan** sub-tab is a delivery note; the **MMR** sub-tab is the material movement register.

- Fill in the seller, consignee, buyer, delivery note details and the goods table on the left; the preview on the right updates as you type.
- **Saved challan** keeps every document; use **New**, **Duplicate** and **Delete** to manage them.
- Click **Export PDF** to save the finished document.

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Calibration Reports

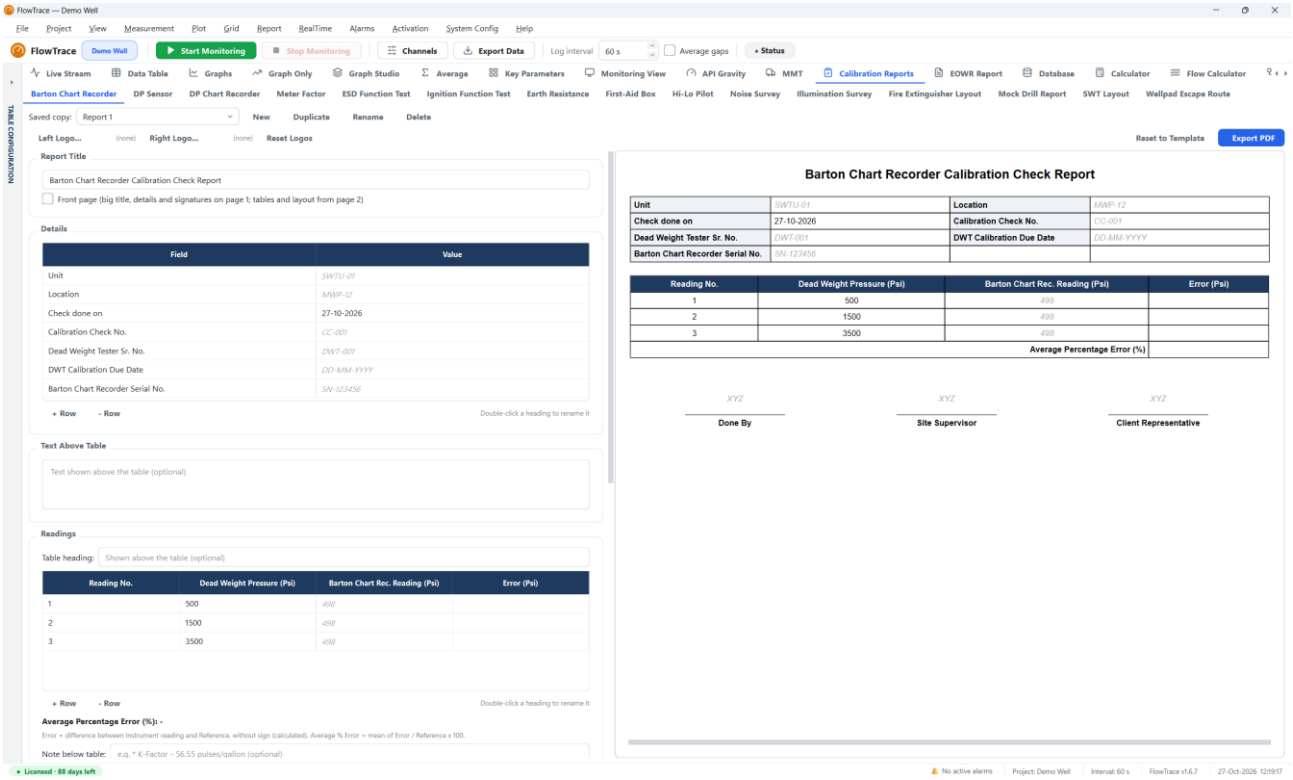


Figure 27: Calibration Reports: Barton Chart Recorder calibration check

Calibration Reports holds ready-made forms for the site checks of a well test job, each on its own sub-tab:

Group	Reports
Instrument calibration	Barton Chart Recorder, DP Sensor, DP Chart Recorder, Meter Factor
Safety function tests	ESD Function Test, Ignition Function Test, Earth Resistance, Hi-Lo Pilot
HSE	First-Aid Box, Noise Survey, Illumination Survey, Fire Extinguisher Layout, Mock Drill Report
Site layouts	SWT Layout, Wellpad Escape Route

1. Pick the report sub-tab.
2. Fill in the details and the reading table on the left. The report preview on the right updates as you type.
3. Optional: add a **Left Logo...** and **Right Logo...**.
4. Click **Export PDF**.

Saved copy keeps several copies of each report (New, Duplicate, Rename, Delete). **Reset to Template** restores the original form.

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P&ID

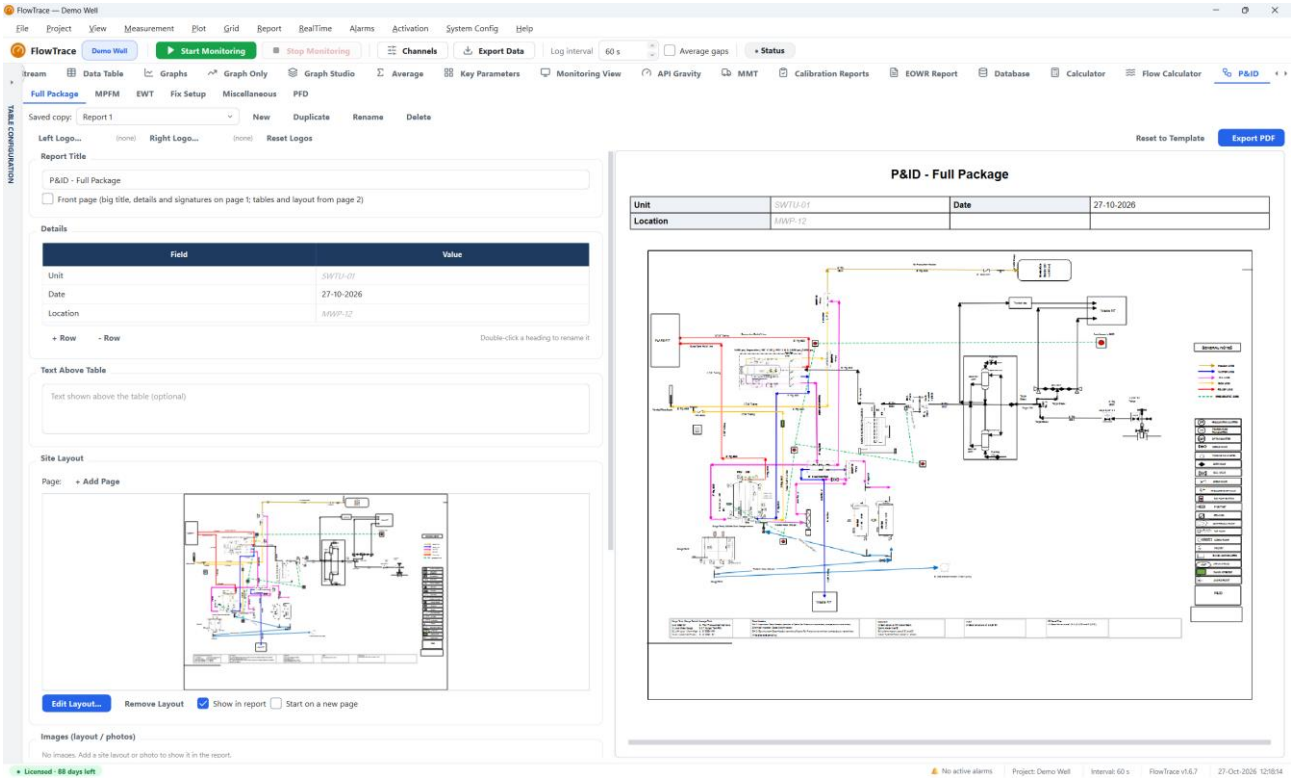


Figure 28: P&ID: Full Package with site layout drawing

The P&ID tab produces piping and instrumentation diagram packages: Full Package, MPFM, EWT, Fix Setup, Miscellaneous and PFD. Each has a report title, details table, site layout drawing (**Edit Layout...**) and images, and is exported with **Export PDF**.

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11 Calculators

These tabs are stand-alone tools. They do not change your logged data.

Average

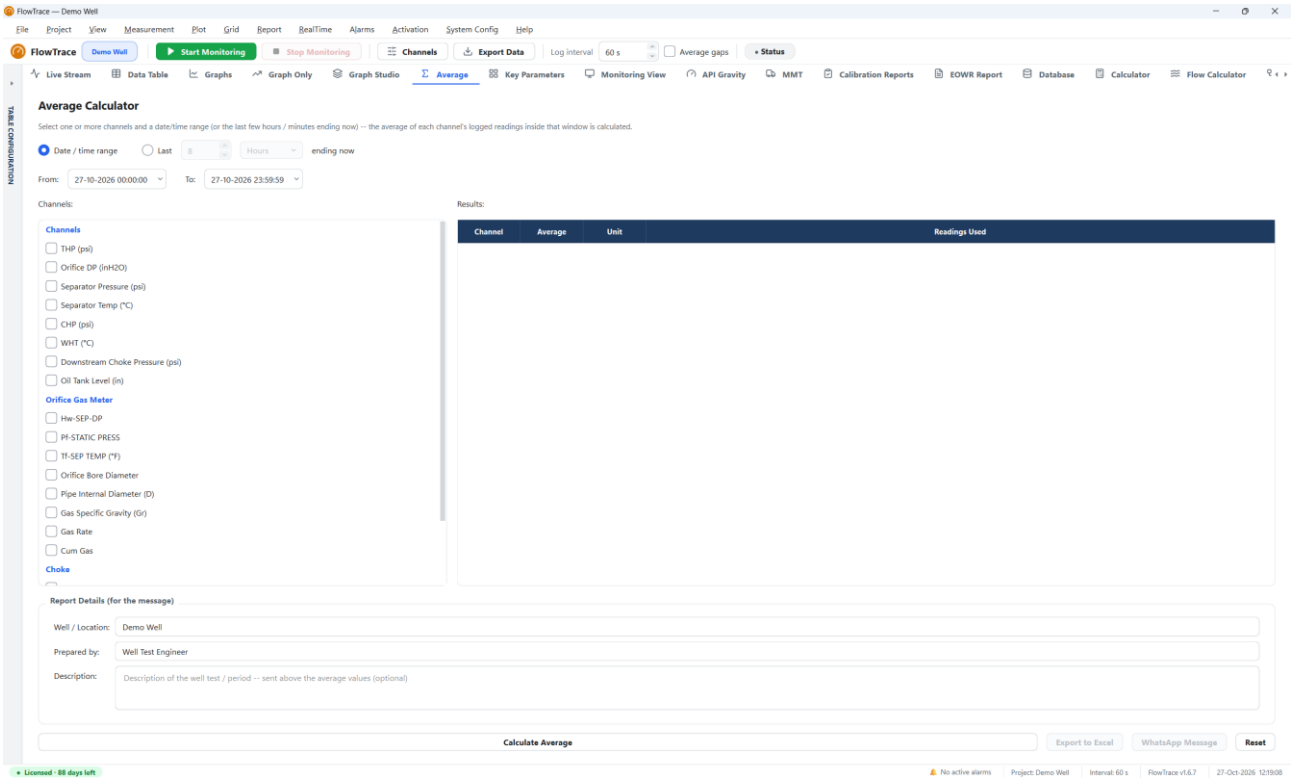


Figure 29: Average Calculator

1. Choose a **Date / time range** (From / To), or **Last** N hours / minutes ending now.
2. Tick the channels and measurement columns to average.
3. Click **Calculate Average**. Each result shows its unit and the number of readings used.
4. Fill in the Report Details and use **Export to Excel** or **WhatsApp Message** to send the results.

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Calculator

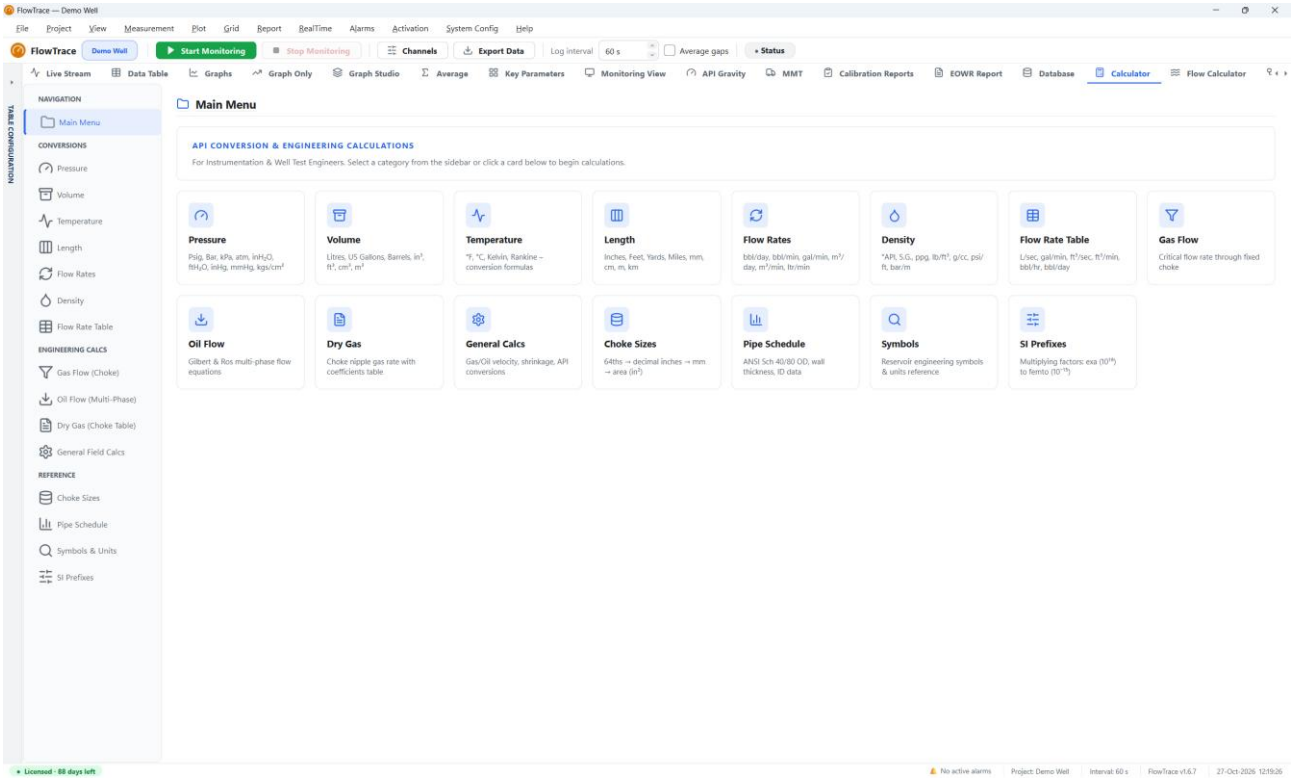


Figure 30: Calculator main menu

Unit conversions (pressure, volume, temperature, length, flow rates, density), gas and oil flow through a choke, dry gas, general field calculations, choke sizes, pipe schedule, symbols and SI prefixes. Pick a card or a sidebar entry.

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Flow Calculator

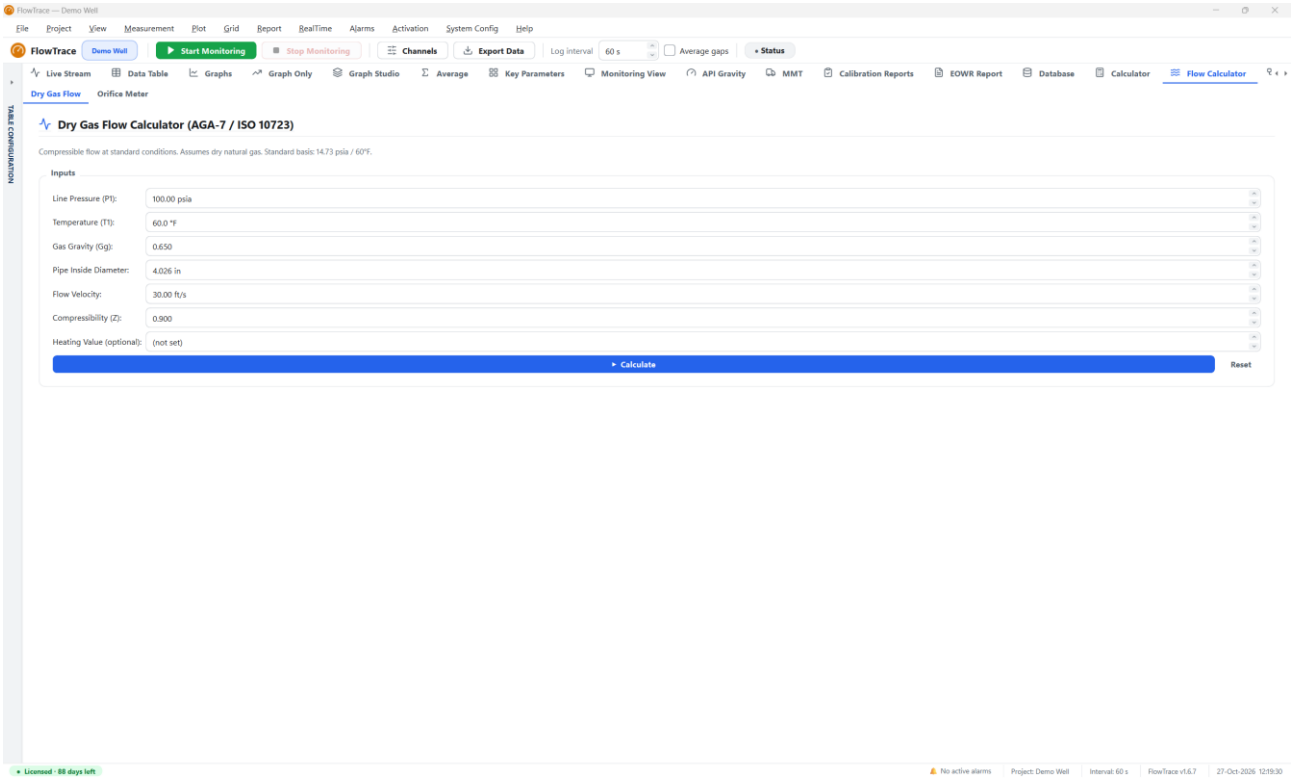


Figure 31: Flow Calculator: Dry Gas Flow

Stand-alone **Dry Gas Flow** (AGA-7 / ISO 10723) and **Orifice Meter** (ISO 5167 / AGA-3) calculators.

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API Gravity

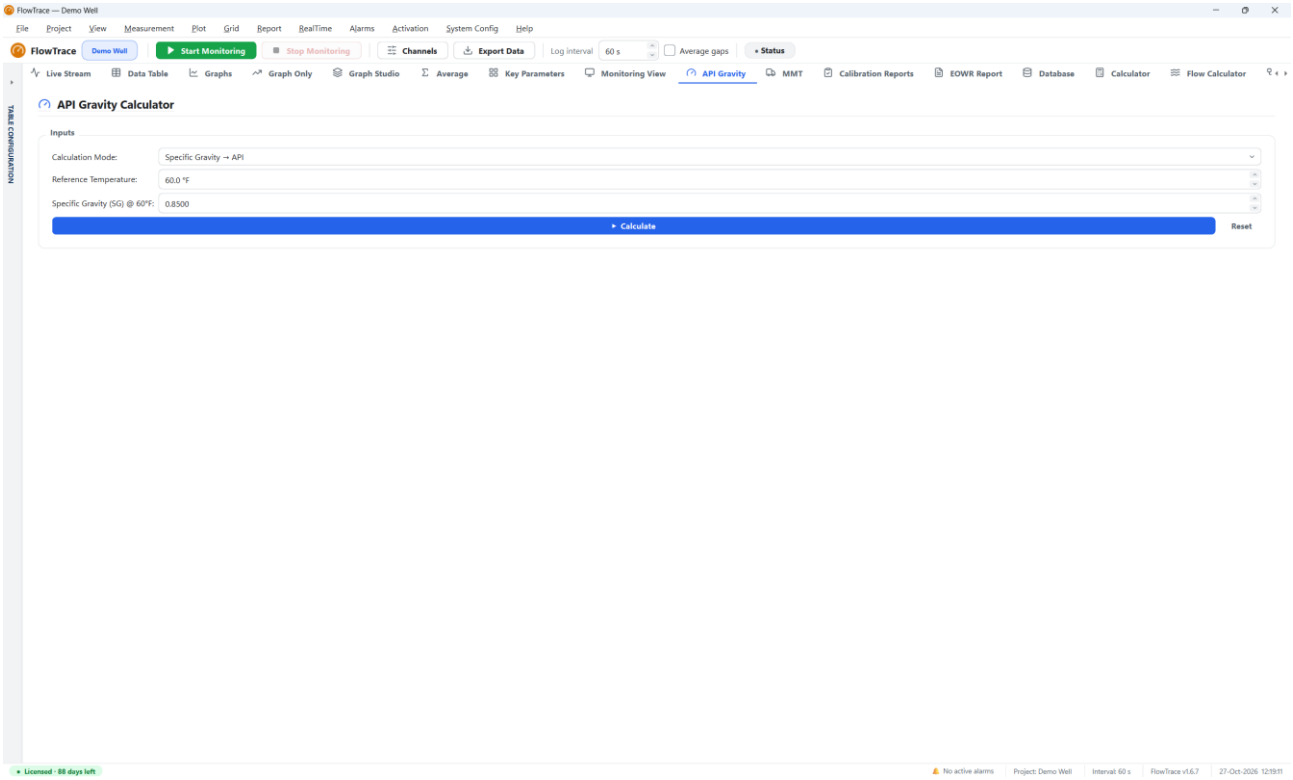


Figure 32: API Gravity Calculator

Converts Specific Gravity, API Gravity and Density into each other at the chosen reference temperature.

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12 Data Management

Database Tab

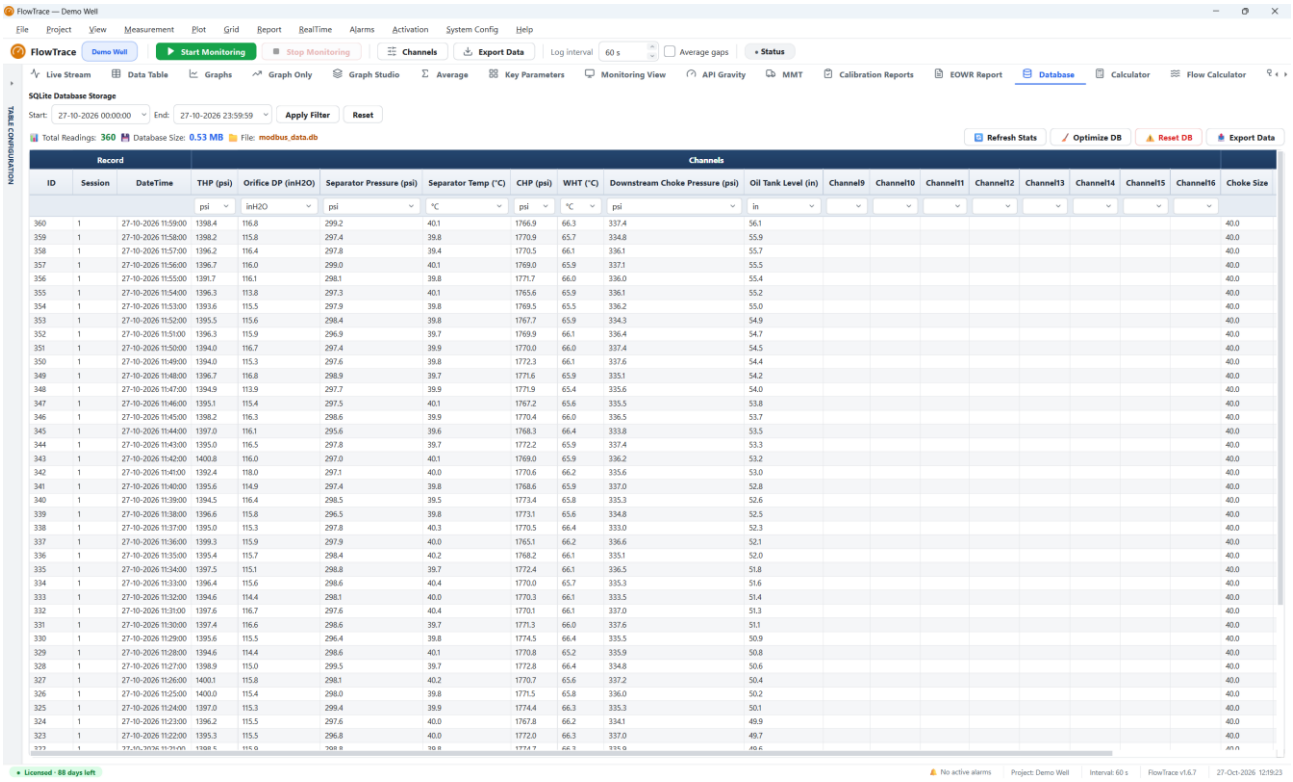


Figure 33: Database tab

- Filter by start and end date, then click **Apply Filter**.
- See total readings, database size and file location.
- **Refresh Stats**: update the numbers.
- **Optimize DB**: compact the database file. Safe; no data is removed.
- **Export Data**: export the database to Excel.
- **Reset DB**: clears all readings of this Project. An Excel backup is saved first and you are asked to confirm.

Important Reset DB cannot be undone inside FlowTrace. Keep the backup file it creates, or use File > Save Project As first.

Where your data is stored

Item	Location
All Projects	Documents\FlowTrace\Projects\<Project name>
Settings of a Project	config.json inside the Project folder

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Readings	modbus_data.db inside the Project folder
CSV logs	Live Log CSV folder in the export path
Automatic upgrade backups	Documents\FlowTrace\Upgrade Backups

- Your data is kept outside the program folder. Installing, reinstalling or uninstalling FlowTrace never deletes it.
- The first time a new version starts, FlowTrace backs up every Project automatically.
- To move a job to another PC: File > Save Project As on the old PC, then Project > Import Project on the new one.

Theme and Display

- **View > Theme**: Light (offices, bright cabins) or Dark (night shifts, dim control rooms). Applies the next time FlowTrace starts. Reports and exports always use light colors.
- **File > Column Order / Visibility...**: arrange and hide columns.
- Column order, hidden columns and graph set-ups are saved with each Project.

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13 Help and Troubleshooting

Built-in Help

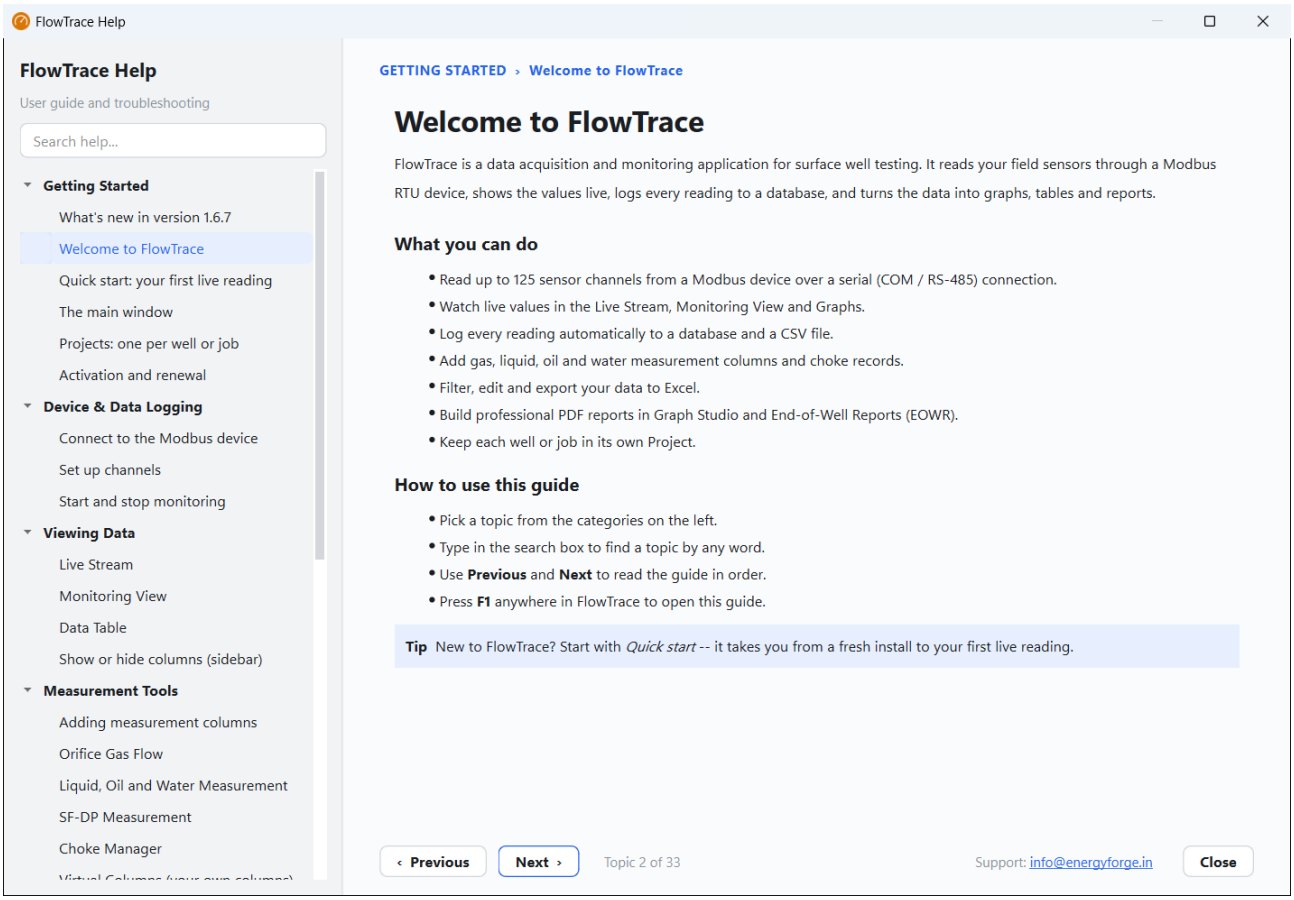


Figure 34: FlowTrace Help (Help > FlowTrace Help, or F1)

The Help window groups the guide into categories on the left. Type in the search box to find a topic, and use **Previous** / **Next** to read in order.

Cannot connect to the device

Message / symptom	What to do
Could not open COM port	Check the cable and converter are plugged in and the port number is correct. Close any other program using the port.
Access is denied	Another program or a hidden duplicate COM port holds the port. In Device Manager > View > Show Hidden Devices > Ports, uninstall grey or duplicate entries, reconnect and try again.
The device did not respond	Baudrate, Parity, Stop Bits or Slave ID do not match the device. Correct them in System Config.

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Connection drops during a job	Monitoring stops safely. Fix the cable or power, then click Start Monitoring; a new session starts and earlier data is kept.

Values look wrong or are missing

- Wrong scale: check the channel Unit, Formula, Multiplier and Offset in Channels.
- Values in the wrong columns: check Start Register and Channel Count against the device register map.
- A column is missing: it may be hidden; tick it in the sidebar.
- Measurement column is empty: open its tool from the Measurement menu and check that every input has a channel.
- Rows missing in the Data Table: reset the date / time filter.

Graphs and exports

Symptom	What to do
Graph is empty	The time window has no data. Set Start / End to a period with readings, or click Reset.
Graph stays zoomed or a band looks squeezed	Axis locks or a manual zoom are active. Use Graph Actions > Reset View.
Excel export fails	The target file is open in Excel. Close it and export again.
EOWR: Office files not converted	Install Microsoft Office, or convert those files to PDF before putting them in the ZIP.

Activation messages

Message	What to do
This activation key is not valid for this computer	The key was made for another Machine Code. Send this computer's Machine Code and ask for a new key.
This key has already been entered on this computer	Nothing to do; check the license status at the bottom left.
This key has been cancelled by the administrator	Ask the administrator for a new key.
Start Monitoring is refused	The license has expired or was cancelled. Open Activation > Activate / Renew... and enter a new key.

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Support

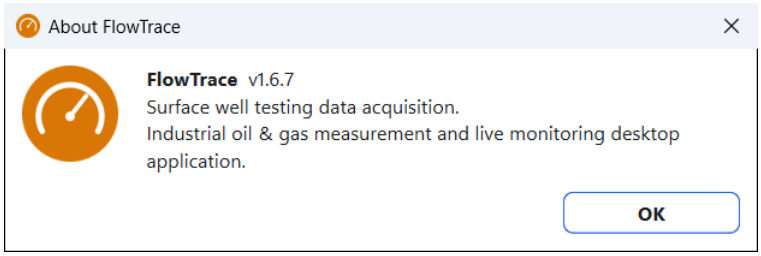


Figure 35: About FlowTrace (Help > About FlowTrace)

Your version number is shown in **Help > About FlowTrace**. Quote it when you contact support.

Support and activation keys: **info@energyforge.in**

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